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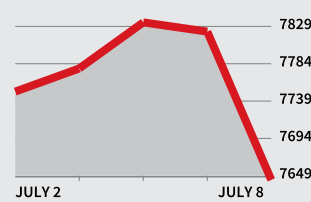
SBI FUNDS MANAGEMENT LIMITED (the “**Company**”) is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions, and other considerations, to undertake an initial public offer of its Equity Shares and has filed a red herring prospectus (“**RHP**”) along with an abridged prospectus each dated July 8, 2026, with the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai – I, Securities and Exchange Board of India (“**SEBI**”), BSE Limited (“**BSE**”) and the National Stock Exchange of India (“**NSE**”, together with “**BSE**”, the “**Stock Exchanges**”). The RHP along with the draft abridged prospectus is available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e., BSE at www.bseindia.com, NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the websites of the BRLMs i.e., Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited at <https://investmentbank.kotak.com>, Axis Capital Limited at www.axiscapital.co.in, BofA Securities India Limited at <https://business.bofa.com/bofas-india>, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited at www.business.hsbc.co.in, ICICI Securities Limited at www.icicisecurities.com, Jefferies India Private Limited at www.jefferies.com, JM Financial Limited at www.jmfml.com, Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited at www.motilaloswal.com and SBI Capital Markets Limited at www.sbicaps.com and the website of our Company at www.sbfunds.com/investor-relations. Potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk. For details, potential investors should refer to the RHP which has been filed with the Registrar of Companies, Mumbai – I, including the section titled “Risk Factors”. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP, or the draft abridged prospectus filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision. The Equity Shares have not been and will not be registered under the U.S. Securities Act or any state securities laws in the United States and may not be offered or sold within the United States or to, or for the account or benefit of, U.S. Persons, except pursuant to an exemption from, or in a transaction not subject to, the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and applicable state securities laws in the United States. The Company has not registered and does not intend to register under the U.S. Investment Company Act in reliance on Section 3(c)(7) of the U.S. Investment Company Act, and investors will not be entitled to the benefits of the U.S. Investment Company Act. Accordingly, the Equity Shares are only being offered and sold (i) to persons in the United States or to, or for the account or benefit of, U.S. Persons, in each case to investors that are both “qualified institutional buyers” (as defined in Rule 144A under the U.S. Securities Act and referred to in the Draft Red Herring Prospectus as “U.S. QIBs” and, for the avoidance of doubt, the term U.S. QIBs does not refer to a category of institutional investor defined under applicable Indian regulations and referred to in the Draft Red Herring Prospectus as “QIBs”) and “qualified purchasers” (as defined under the U.S. Investment Company Act and referred to in the Draft Red Herring Prospectus as “QPS”) in transactions exempt from or not subject to the registration requirements of the U.S. Securities Act and in reliance on Section 3(c)(7) of the U.S. Investment Company Act; or (ii) outside the United States to investors that are not U.S. Persons nor persons acquiring for the account or benefit of U.S. Persons in “offshore transactions” as defined in, and in reliance on, Regulation S under the U.S. Securities Act and the applicable laws of the jurisdiction where those offers and sales occur.

sbifunds.com

Mutual Fund investments are subject to market risks, read all scheme related documents carefully.

the hindu businessline

SENSEX 76503.60 (-1677.12)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23882.05	-516.65
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.76	-0.46
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.56	+0.60
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	141780.00	-1726
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	221550.00	-5650

ALARM BELLS.

Rising fertilizer supply risks threaten crop yields in developing nations, potentially hurting global food security **p8**



AFFORDABILITY PUSH.

Airlines urge government to lower GST on ATF to reduce operating costs and airfares **p10**

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QUICKLY.

LOWER PROJECTION
IMF trims India FY27
growth forecast to 6.4%



New Delhi: The International Monetary Fund (IMF) on Wednesday lowered India's growth forecast for the current fiscal (financial year 2026-27) by 10 basis points to 6.4 per cent. However, it retained the tag of the fastest growing economy and upped the growth projection for the next fiscal by 20 basis points to 6.7 per cent. For calendar 2026, IMF's growth projections for India are 7 per cent, and 6.4 per cent for 2027. **p3**

'BENEFICIAL OWNER'
SEBI mulls easing FPI
disclosure norms

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is examining a proposal to raise the existing 3 per cent cap on composite holdings of foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) eligible for exemption from making additional disclosures under the regulator's beneficial ownership framework, sources said. **p6**

Sensex tanks over 2% as crude rises on West Asia war fears

ALL FALL DOWN. Investors lose ₹9 lakh crore with all sectoral indices in the red

Suresh P Iyengar
K Ram Kumar
Mumbai

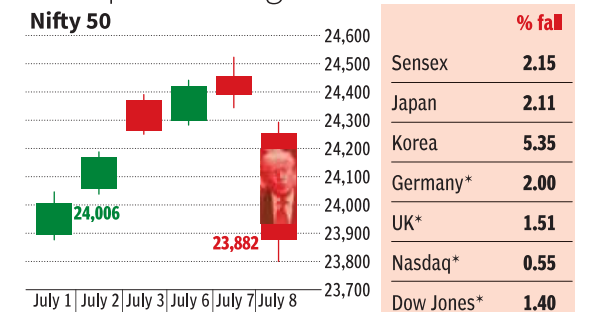
Indian equities witnessed their sharpest single-day decline in four months on Wednesday after a sharp deterioration in global risk sentiment triggered by US President Donald Trump's remarks suggesting the ceasefire with Iran had effectively collapsed, raising fears of a fresh escalation in West Asia.

The BSE Sensex plunged 1,677 points, or 2.15 per cent, to close at 76,504, while the broader Nifty 50 index fell 517 points, or 2.12 per cent, to end at 23,882. The last steeper decline was recorded on March 30, when the benchmark index had dropped 2.22 per cent.

The sell-off wiped out nearly ₹9 lakh crore of investor wealth, dragging the BSE market capitalisation to ₹471.2 lakh crore. Selling intensified during the final 90 minutes of trade as investors rushed to cut risk exposure.

The benchmark 10-year government bond yield

Trump shocks again



Note: Green candles indicate positive close; red negative *8:30 pm IST

hardened by 7 basis points to close at 6.76 per cent.

VOLATILITY SURGE

India VIX surged 26 per cent to 14.68, its biggest single-day jump since April 7, signalling expectations of elevated market volatility. The sell-off was broad-based, with all 30 BSE Sensex constituents ending in the red. FMCG and private banking stocks were the biggest losers. Mid-cap and small-caps came under heavy pressure as investors shifted to a risk-off mode.

Despite the market rout, institutional investors remained net buyers. Foreign

portfolio investors purchased equities worth ₹1,963 crore, while domestic institutional investors recorded net purchases of ₹790 crore.

BUYING OPPORTUNITY

A Balasubramanian, Managing Director of Aditya Birla Sun Life AMC, said the [West Asia] conflict is unlikely to be prolonged as it would hurt all stakeholders.

He added that sharp market corrections should be viewed as buying opportunities and expressed confidence that growth-supportive policy measures and a higher weightage for India in global indices could help attract

foreign capital and support the rupee.

Manish Bhandari, CEO and Portfolio Manager at Vallum Capital, said investors should get accustomed to higher volatility. "The three-year phase of largely unidirectional gains is behind us. Global capital is extremely mobile and markets are increasingly reacting to geopolitical events, trade disputes, oil prices and policy actions," he said.

Market participants will now shift their focus to the June-quarter earnings season, with TCS results expected to provide the first major clues on the broader corporate earnings outlook.

Rupee down 60 paise at 95.56/\$

The rupee posted its worst single-day decline in about a month, dropping 60 paise to close at 95.56 per dollar against the previous close of 94.96. During the session, the rupee touched an intra-day low of 95.60 per dollar.

Read more p3

Crude rises above \$80/bbl as Trump ends Iran truce

Bloomberg

Oil jumped above \$80 a barrel after US President Donald Trump said a tentative ceasefire with Iran was over, reigniting geopolitical risk premium in prices and triggering investor concern about supply disruptions.

Brent futures rose more than 7 per cent to trade near \$80 a barrel, while West Texas Intermediate also leaped to around \$75.50 a barrel. Diesel futures led the energy complex higher, surging more than 13 per cent after Russia banned diesel exports.

Trump warned that oil prices could rise further as the administration mulls more strikes on Iran that may include the key export hub of Kharg Island.

Read more p8

In a first, 'assets under control' of MFs surpass those of FPIs on strong SIP inflows

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Thanks to the exuberance of retail investors, the assets under control (AUC) of mutual funds across debt, equity and ETFs have surpassed those of foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) for the first time, driven by steady inflows of over ₹30,000 crore into mutual funds through SIPs.

The AUC of mutual funds stood at ₹76.41 lakh crore, while that of FPIs was marginally lower at ₹76.22 lakh crore as of June-end, according to NSDL data.

OVERALL ASSETS

Despite foreign investors selling heavily in the equity markets, FPI holdings remained higher at ₹68.65 lakh

The AUC of MFs stood at ₹76.41 lakh crore, while that of FPIs was marginally lower at ₹76.22 lakh crore

crore, while mutual fund holdings stood at ₹54.50 lakh crore.

FPIs pulled out \$28 billion from equity markets over the last six months amid concerns over elevated valuations, subdued returns and rising crude oil prices driven by escalating geopolitical tensions.

HEAVY ON DEBT, ETFs

Mutual fund assets in debt and ETFs stood at ₹21.91

lakh crore, significantly higher than the ₹7.58 lakh crore in FPI debt assets held across the general, fully accessible route (FAR), voluntary retention route (VRR) and hybrid categories.

A mutual fund cannot invest through the VRR route as it is meant exclusively for FPIs.

Apart from equities, investors are allocating capital to debt funds and exchange-traded funds, driven by the attractive risk-return profiles of debt and multi-asset products.

STRUCTURAL SHIFT

Aditya Agrawal, Chief Investment Officer at Avisa Wealth Creators, said, "The fact that mutual funds have overtaken FPIs in overall assets marks a structural shift in India's capital markets,

driven by consistent SIP inflows, rising retail participation, and increasing adoption of debt and ETF products."

The equity holdings gap is likely to narrow gradually if domestic inflows continue at the current pace. However, overtaking FPIs in equities could still take a few years, given their sizeable existing equity base, he said.

Shashank Udupa, Founder of Vayu Capital, said FPIs still lead mutual funds by about ₹14 lakh crore in equity holdings, and much of that advantage has been built over 2-3 decades through investments in large-cap stocks and index constituents.

In contrast, the strong SIP-driven growth in mutual funds is a relatively recent phenomenon of 5-7 years.

RAINS RETURN



WATERLOGGING WOES. Trains run on flooded tracks in the Vasai-Virar section of Palghar as rains returned to Maharashtra on Wednesday after a brief respite. There was widespread waterlogging, transport disruption and power outage across the State. Western Railway cancelled services beyond Vasai as water flowed over tracks. At least nine Mumbai-bound flights were cancelled. Palghar continues to remain under the Met Department's red alert. **p11**

S. Africa's Sanlam ups stake in Shriram Life for fast expansion, to prioritise bank tie-ups

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

South Africa's Sanlam Group has increased its stake in Shriram Life Insurance Corporation (SLIC) through a primary fund infusion of around ₹310 crore and a buy-out of existing investors, as the insurer accelerates plans to expand its coverage to a wider population.

Shriram Life Insurance is a joint venture between the financial conglomerate Shriram Group and South Africa-based financial services group Sanlam. With this, Sanlam's stake in SLIC has crossed the halfway mark, standing at 52.05 per cent as of June, up from around 38 per cent in December 2025.

The funds will go towards strengthening the life insurer's balance sheet and powering growth plans, including technology ramp-up, distribution partnerships

and tailored products.

SLIC posted 16 per cent growth in FY26, lower than the robust growth recorded in the previous three fiscals as a slew of regulatory changes, such as surrender value and GST rate cut, weighed on the business.

DECENT GROWTH

"Sixteen per cent is a decent growth for us after three years of strong growth. We tripled the size of the company in just around three years, this despite being a mid-size company already," Casparus JH Kromhout, MD and CEO, Shriram Life Insurance, told *businessline* in an interaction.

"This year (FY27), we will grow around 20 per cent as we accelerate plans to tie up more, larger banking partnerships," he added.

"The government's 'insurance for all' goal will require the industry to sell more policies to under-served



Casparus JH Kromhout, MD and CEO, Shriram Life Insurance. BUJOY GHOSH

markets. For every 100 policies that we sold in 2010, we are selling 384 policies in 2026," said Kromhout.

The recent geopolitical tensions also played out in the business in FY26. "We were actually on track for 20 per cent growth in FY26, but ended up at 16 per cent because the final jump in March did not materialise."

Looking ahead, Shriram Life is prioritising bank partnerships. Having established linkages with cooperative and regional rural banks, the

insurer is now mooted conversations with relatively larger private banks for distribution. "We continue to build on our agency strength," Kromhout said.

"We have also upped our focus on renewals," said the MD, noting a 13-month persistency ratio of around 65 per cent as of FY26. The target is to reach it to 70 per cent in FY27.

FIRST-TIME BUYERS

SLIC focuses on all segments, but the bulk of its business comes from the ₹5-15 lakh annual income group, with an emphasis on first-time buyers. This goal got a leg up in FY26 as 53 per cent of its new retail policies came from rural areas compared to the previous year (35 per cent). The insurer, which is today the third-largest in the rural segment, sold 541,409 policies in FY26 and paid out around ₹795 crore across 77,790 claims.

‘Global first, local next’ is biotech start-ups’ playbook

Western validation helps in funding research and accelerating growth

Aishwarya Kumar
Bengaluru

The first customers for Mestastop, a Bengaluru-based start-up developing therapies to stop cancer metastasis (the spread of cancer from the primary tumour to other organs), aren't in India.

"They're abroad," says Founder Arnab Roy Choudhary. "For deep-tech products, awareness and understanding are much higher globally. The Indian market often waits for Western validation before embracing new technologies."

BROADER SHIFT

His experience reflects a broader shift. Long before commercialising products at home, a growing number of Indian biotech start-ups are generating their first revenues from customers in the US and Europe.

"The economics are com-



VALUE PLAY. With foreign customers often willing to pay more, these firms leverage India's pharma expertise to develop innovative cures

PELLING," says Mayur Sirdeesai, Managing Partner at Somersat Indus Capital Partners. A US biotech company typically pays within 30-45 days and offers gross margins of 35-40 per cent, while Indian buyers often negotiate aggressively, operate on payment cycles stretching up to six months and offer significantly lower margins.

"A start-up can generate \$500,000-\$2 million in annual recurring revenue within two years selling glob-

ally, enough to fund hiring and R&D." However, commercialising abroad does not mean abandoning India.

For Mestastop, global markets will remain the primary revenue driver, although Choudhary insists India remains strategically important as demand grows for high-quality, locally developed biotech products.

Not every company is following the export-first route, though. Immuneel Therapeutics chose to commer-

cialise in India first. "Our vision has always been India first, global next," says CEO Amit Mookim, adding that the company wanted to prove India could develop and commercialise globally benchmarked CAR-T-Cell therapies.

Investors, however, believe the trend of exporting first reflects the industry's evolution. Vedha Sampathkumar, Partner at Endiava Partners, said Indian biotech today mirrors the SaaS boom: Companies are building in India but selling globally. With the US and Europe remaining the largest markets for innovative therapeutics, start-ups are leveraging India's pharmaceutical expertise and cost advantage to develop globally competitive products.

The playbook is becoming increasingly clear: Build in India, commercialise overseas and eventually bring the innovations back home.

QUICKLY.

M&M to hike SUVs, CV range price from July 10



New Delhi: Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M), on Wednesday, said in a statement that it will hike prices of its SUVs and commercial vehicle (CV) range by 2.7 per cent and 2 per cent, respectively, on an average from July 10, to offset the increase in commodity costs. The extent of the price increase will vary across specific products, the company added in a statement. [PTI](#)

Nalco, NLCIL sign JV for 1,080-MW power plant

New Delhi: State-owned National Aluminium Company (Nalco), on Wednesday, said in a regulatory filing that it would enter into a joint venture-cum-shareholders' agreement (JVA) with NLC India (NLCIL) to set up a 1,080-MW thermal captive power plant in Anugola, Odisha. The plant will supply captive power to Nalco's 0.5-mtpa aluminium smelter expansion project, it added. [PTI](#)

JLR looks to bounce back with new models, modern luxury push after a tough FY26

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Jaguar Land Rover (JLR) is betting on a new product cycle, a sharper modern luxury strategy and closer integration with Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles (TMPV) to revive growth after a difficult FY26, as the British luxury carmaker looks to move past tariff disruptions and a cyber incident that dented its financial performance.

Speaking to shareholders at the 81st AGM on Wednesday, Chairman N Chandrasekaran said JLR's next phase will be driven by next-generation vehicle launches, a strengthened leadership team and deeper technology and manufacturing synergies with Tata Motors.

He added that the com-

'Better charging infrastructure on highways is driving EV sales'

RACING AHEAD. BMW Group India is No 1 luxury EV brand with 2,359 units sold in H1

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

BMW Group India on Wednesday said that charging infrastructure on the highways is getting better, on top of the increased range in several newer vehicles, which were resulting in better sales volumes for electric vehicles (EVs) in the country.

For BMW Group India, models like i7 and iX1 are selling better than its internal combustion engine (ICE) with a ratio of 60:40, and may further increase in the future, Hardeep Singh Brar, President and Chief Executive Officer, said.

"We believe in fast chargers and we have put 12 such chargers of 120Kw and above with 720Kw being the highest between Kashmir and Kanyakumari at a distance of around 250 km each. So, I think the most important thing is to focus more on the highways. Sometimes, we tend to focus more on cities, but in cities, there is no problem any more. Most of the commercial and residential buildings have chargers



Hardeep Singh Brar, President and CEO, BMW Group India

now, and I also feel the charging infra utilisation will be very low in the cities," Brar told *businessline*.

He said if more chargers are put up on the highways, it'll give more confidence to customers to buy an EV because that's where the anxiety is and the anxiety is never inside the cities.

RETAIL SALES

In terms of retail sales, the company has also become number one luxury EV brand in India with 2,359 EVs delivered to customers during the first half (H1) of this calendar year (January-June).

The EV demand has risen

exceptionally, growing 78 per cent year-on-year and 69 per cent market share in luxury EVs market.

"The EV penetration to total sales stood at 26 per cent in H1 compared to 18 per cent same time last year, making every fourth car that BMW Group India sold an EV, and by end of this year, we expect EVs to contribute 28 per cent to our overall sales," he said.

Brar said because of the West Asia crisis and a lot of discussions around fuel prices going up, there was a shift towards EVs. "When you know your fuel prices are going up by another ₹7-8,

there is a bit of an uncertainty among customers about what is going to happen. We also see a lot of diesel customers shifting now (to EVs) because the range has gone beyond 500 km per charge," he explained.

On asked about ethanol blending and government hinting to go beyond E20, Brar said, "We are very compliant with the E25, so there are customer queries and we are trying to explain to them that we are complying. The only thing we want is a certainty (from the government) on by when they want to go to E30, E40 or flex fuels. I think that clarity is very important. Adhering to regulation is not an issue, it's how much time you get to adhere to that is a challenge."

Meanwhile, the company reported a record sales of 9,075 units in H1 of this year, a growth of 17 per cent, while in April-June, it delivered 4,507 cars with 17 per cent growth. With such performance in the H1, the company aims to cross annual sales of 20,000 units in India for the first time this year, he added.

TVS Motor, IOC tie up for better last-mile LPG distribution

Our Bureau
Chennai

TVS Motor Company, part of TVS Venu, a global manufacturer of two- and three-wheelers, on Wednesday announced a partnership with Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) to strengthen last-mile LPG cylinder distribution through sustainable commercial mobility solutions.

As part of the initiative, TVS Motor Company will work with IOC network of over 13,000 LPG distributors across the country, enabling the adoption of the TVS King Kargo HD vehicles for door-step cylinder deliveries.

This marks an important step towards enabling cleaner, more efficient and cost-effective LPG cylinder distribution, said a company release.

VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic: Visveswaran V

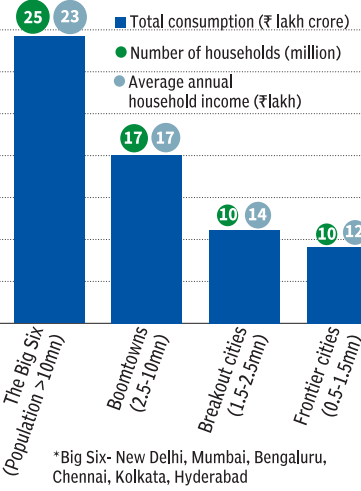
Urban India drives consumption

India's consumption is increasingly being shaped by its large cities. According to *The Many Urban Indias* report by PRICE and Tata, the country's top 100 cities are projected to account for ₹74.5 lakh crore in consumption in 2025-26, representing 61 per cent of urban demand. The report also highlights shifting household spending patterns, rising savings and the growing importance of emerging urban centres in driving India's consumption story



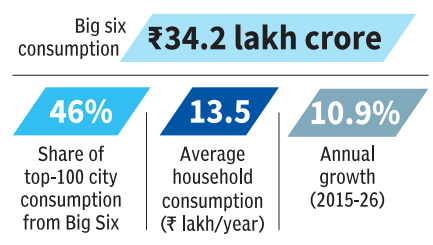
The Big Six generate nearly half of urban consumption

India's urban consumption by city group



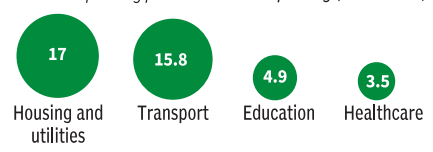
Big Six cities contribute 46% of top-100 city consumption

Consumption across Big Six



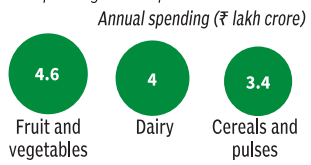
Housing and transport dominate urban household budgets

Household spending pattern



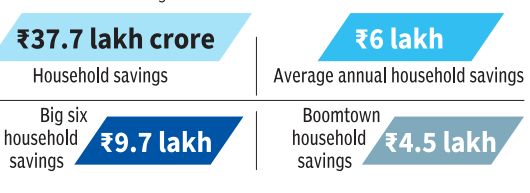
Fruit and vegetable spending reaches ₹4.6 lakh crore

Food spending in the top 100 cities



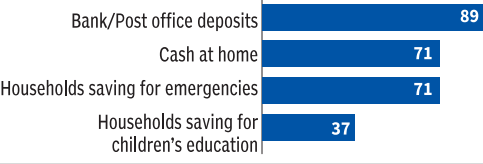
Urban households save ₹37.7 lakh crore annually

Urban household savings

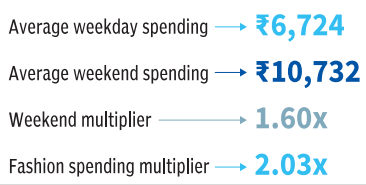


Bank remains the preferred savings instrument

Where urban India saves



Weekends account for most discretionary spending



Source: *The Many Urban Indias* report by People Research on India's Consumer Economy (PRICE) and TATA

HFCL to invest ₹950 crore for new brand OptiQ AI over two years

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

HFCL, a technology enterprise providing telecom and network infrastructure, announced a new brand identity, OptiQ AI, for its integrated optical connectivity portfolio, comprising optical fibre cables and accessories designed for AI, cloud and hyperscale data centres.

The company would invest ₹950 crore over the next two years to expand its manufacturing capacity, Ma-

hendra Nahata, Managing Director, HFCL, said.

The new brand brings together HFCL's established data centre optical fibre cable and accessories offerings, including fibre cable assemblies, patch cords, trunks, cassettes and enclosure panels. "The newly-launched OptiQ AI is designed to provide complete, passive data centre solutions. While the company is already supplying fibre-optic cables in large quantities to interconnect data centres, the new product line ex-

pands functionality within the facilities," he said.

FAST DEPLOYMENT

"For hyperscalers, this means faster deployment cycles, reduced interoperability risks and future-ready infrastructure supporting seamless migration to 800G and 1.6T networks," Nahata said. "We are planning to increase the capacity from 30 million to 40 million fibre kilometres per year. Similarly, we would increase cable capacity from 39 million to 45 million fibre km."

EV start-ups chase software revenues as margins tighten on vehicle sales

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

As competition intensifies in India's electric vehicle (EV) market and hardware margins come under pressure, start-ups are increasingly betting on software, data and fleet intelligence to build recurring revenue streams and improve profitability.

Founders across the mobility ecosystem told *businessline* that commercial fleet operators are demanding services such as predictive maintenance, battery analytics, fleet management, charging optimisation and AI-powered route planning, signalling a shift from selling vehicles to offering integrated mobility platforms.

"The EV industry is rapidly shifting from a product-centric model to a platform-centric model," said Hiten Pal Saklani, CEO-Designate, BikeWo Green Tech. "While vehicle sales remain important, we see significantly higher long-term value in recurring technology and service revenues through fleet management, predictive maintenance, battery health analytics, financing enablement and energy management." He expects software,



CHANGING BETS. The shift comes with shrinking hardware margins amid rising competition, localisation efforts and pricing pressure. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

fleet management and energy services to contribute 25-35 per cent of the company's revenues over the next three-five years.

The shift comes as vehicle manufacturers grapple with shrinking hardware margins amid rising competition, localisation efforts and pricing pressure. Instead of relying solely on one-time vehicle sales, start-ups are looking to generate predictable cash flows through subscription-based digital services.

Tarun Jain, Co-founder of LetzRyd, said the company is seeing growing demand for connected mobility solutions. Hardware margins have become more competitive, prompting the company to deepen its focus on recurring software revenues.

For fleet customers, the buying decision is also evolving. "Customers are asking for certainty rather than just vehicles," said Nikhil Anand Khurana, Managing Director and CEO, Folks Motor. "They want battery health, charging patterns, downtime risks, maintenance schedules and total cost of ownership in real

time. What they really value is uptime, predictability, financing support and operational control." He added that the company's future growth will increasingly come from combining fleet intelligence, battery analytics, charging infrastructure and financing into a unified operating ecosystem.

The emergence of software-led services is also creating opportunities for companies building technology around commercial fleets.

INDIA MARKET

Rahul Mehra, Co-founder of Roadcast, said customers are increasingly seeking "complete operational intelligence rather than just vehicle tracking". "Competitive advantage no longer comes from the device itself but from the intelligence built around it," he said.

Industry executives believe the next phase of India's EV market will be defined less by vehicle specifications and more by the software layer that improves fleet uptime, lowers operating costs and strengthens customer retention.

Brokerages see TCS' Q1 margins falling due to flat revenue growth

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Brokerage firms expect Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) to report a decline in margins in the first quarter of FY27, along with largely-flat revenue growth.

Q1 PREVIEW.

Analysts estimate EBIT margins could contract by 140-160 basis points (bps) sequentially, primarily due to company-wide wage revisions implemented during the quarter, as well as a revenue shortfall.

"We expect EBIT margin to decline sharply to 23.9 per cent, largely due to the annual wage hike effective April, partly offset by pro-

ductivity improvements, operational efficiencies and favourable currency movements," said Motilal Oswal Financial Services in its research note.

However, Choice Institutional Equities expects margins to remain stable at 25.4 per cent, foreseeing the wage hike impact to be offset by productivity gains, operational efficiencies and favourable foreign exchange.

MUTED GROWTH

Further, firms projected a modest 0.1-0.9 per cent revenue growth on a sequential basis, constrained by macro headwinds, AI-driven cost pressures and cautious discretionary spending, partly offset by steady execution in BFSI and Consumer segments. Kotak Institutional

Ford Motor launches third centre at Coimbatore

Rohan Das
Chennai

Ford Business Solutions (FBS) India, the global capability centre (GCC) arm of automotive major Ford Motor, has launched a new centre at Coimbatore in Tamil Nadu. This is the company's third centre in India after large operations in Chennai and a smaller centre in Bengaluru that it opened recently.

The 800-seat centre in Coimbatore will predominantly house the company's accounting, financing (Ford Credit) and other business operations. Speaking to *businessline*, Gangapriya Chakraverti, In-

dia Site Head and Managing Director, FBS, said that the office is being built as a business continuity hub designed to ensure critical operations continue in case the company's primary GCC in Chennai is disrupted.

LOCAL TALENT

"We earlier operated a centre in Coimbatore, which we closed during the Covid pandemic. We have had positive experience with the local talent pool here, especially in terms of quality and the range of talent across commercial, operational and engineering operations," she said. Beyond backup operations, some accounting teams will actually be led out of Coimbatore, she added.



(from left) Pavankumar G Giriappanavar, Coimbatore Collector; S Keerthana, TN Minister for Industries; Gangapriya Chakraverti, India Site Head and Managing Director, FBS; and Deepak Jacob, MD & CEO, Guidance Tamil Nadu

The Coimbatore facility spans over 82,000 sq ft.

"There is a lot of change that is happening within Ford with a lot of new systems being put in place, par-

and whether it will reflect in higher numbers here," Chakraverti said.

Though Ford currently has no intent to expand the centre's scope into engineering or technology teams, she did not rule out the possibility given the strong automotive ecosystem and availability of good engineering talent in Coimbatore.

Keerthana Sampath, Minister of Industries, Investment Promotion & Commerce, Government of Tamil Nadu, said in a statement that Ford's decision to open this centre in Coimbatore is a strong endorsement of Tamil Nadu's standing as a destination for global capability and knowledge-based industries.

businessline.
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US may strike Iran again, says Trump

GROWING TENSIONS. President threatens to hit Tehran’s infrastructure sites, resume blockade on the ports

Bloomberg

President Donald Trump said the US would probably launch further strikes on Iran and could resume a blockade on the country’s ports, ratcheting up pressure on Tehran and raising the prospect of a return to all-out war.

“We hit them very hard last night,” Trump said on Wednesday on the sidelines of the NATO summit in Ankara, Turkey. “Probably hit them hard again tonight.”

Trump spoke hours after the US launched strikes on Iran and revoked a waiver that allowed Tehran to sell its oil globally, measures Washington said were in response to attacks on ships in the Strait of Hormuz that it blamed on the Islamic Republic.

The moves posed the greatest threat yet to a ceasefire deal between the US and Iran and talks toward a broader agreement to end the war.

An Iranian advisor to the country’s supreme leader said in a post on X that Tehran would deliver an “im-



ESCALATING PRESSURE. US President Donald Trump with NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte on the sidelines of the NATO summit in Ankara, Turkey **REUTERS**

mediate response” to the US.

Both the US and Iran have accused each other of violating a memorandum of understanding which established a short-term truce and set in motion a 60-day period for negotiations on a broader deal. That agreement also saw the US lift a blockade of Iranian ports.

“We may put it back, the blockade, and it’ll only be a blockade for Iran,” Trump said.

He also said the US could escalate by bombing infrastructure targets like desal-

ination and power plants, repeating threats he made earlier in the conflict. Trump has in the past threatened strikes only to change his mind.

OIL PRICES SOAR

Oil prices climbed for a second day on Wednesday with fresh worries about the flow of energy through the Strait of Hormuz. Economies around the world have been hit by higher costs from the war started by the US and Israel in late February.

Earlier, Trump said he

thought the ceasefire was “over,” though, he added he would not stop negotiators from continuing to engage.

“I guess they can talk. But I’m not seeing it,” Trump said.

Issues to be resolved in discussions include management of the strait, Iran’s nuclear program and the release of billions of dollars of frozen funds to the Islamic Republic, but little headway has been made on any of the topics.

Iran’s Foreign Ministry said earlier that US attacks

and the block on oil sales had rendered the interim peace deal “ineffective.”

Violations of Iran’s control over Hormuz and continued Israeli attacks in Lebanon have added to Tehran’s concerns, the ministry said.

The US for its part has blamed Iran for attacks on three ships in recent days. Iran has said repeatedly it won’t allow vessels to transit the crucial energy waterway without its permission.

The US military said it carried out strikes on more than 80 sites in Iran overnight, hitting air defence systems, command and control networks and coastal radar sites.

The Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps said it struck military bases in Kuwait and Bahrain, according to a statement carried by Iran’s state television.

Negotiations between the US and Iran are currently suspended.

India seeks safe passage for 9 ships as Hormuz truce falters

Bloomberg

India is considering options, including holding talks with Iran, in order to secure safe passage for at least nine laden tankers waiting in the Persian Gulf as attacks in the waterway threaten an already fragile interim ceasefire.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s government is closely monitoring the movement of these vessels loaded with crude oil and liquefied petroleum gas,

people familiar with the matter said, asking not to be named because the discussions are private.

Among other steps, the Foreign Ministry will contact Iranian authorities over the safety of Indian seafarers in the region, the people said, with hundreds stranded for months since the Strait of Hormuz was effectively closed. That includes 198 mariners onboard the nine tankers ready to transit through the thoroughfare.

IMF slashes India’s FY27 growth forecast to 6.4%, but retains tag of fastest growing economy

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The International Monetary Fund (IMF) on Wednesday lowered India’s growth forecast for the current fiscal 2026-27 by 10 basis points to 6.4 per cent.

However, it has retained the tag of fastest growing economy for the country and upped the growth projection for the next fiscal 2027-28 by 20 basis points to 6.7 per cent.

“India remains among the fastest growing major economies, with growth projec-

ted at 6.4 per cent, supported by strong momentum in private consumption and services activity,” IMF said in its latest update on the World Economic Outlook (WEO).

In its April edition, the institution had revised the growth estimates upward moderately by 0.3 percentage point (0.1 percentage point relative to January) to 6.5 per cent, led by positive contributions from the carryover of the strong 2025 out-turn and the decline in additional US tariffs on Indian goods from 50 per cent to 10 per cent, which out-



The IMF’s growth projection for India is 7% for CY2026 and 6.4% for 2027

weighed the adverse impact of the West Asia conflict.

Meanwhile, the IMF’s growth projection for India

is 7 per cent for calendar year 2026 and 6.4 per cent for calendar year 2027.

IMF’s projection for FY27 is on the lower side as compared to other agencies. Driven by de-escalation optimism surrounding the US-Iran interim agreement, HDFC Bank recently upgraded India’s FY27 growth forecast by 20 basis points to 6.7 per cent.

The revision led a series of new projections, with S&P Global setting its headline growth figure at 6.6 per cent and Bank of Baroda estimating the trajectory to settle between 6.4 per cent and 6.6

per cent as maritime trade routes normalise.

All these projections are lower than FY26 print of 7.7 per cent. However, while IMF’s latest print is lower than RBI’s revised projection of 6.6 per cent, all others are close to or at par with the central bank number, revised last month.

GLOBAL OUTLOOK

Talking about the global economy, WEO said that it is in crosscurrents of war and technology.

“Global growth is projected to be 3.0 per cent in 2026 and 3.4 per cent in 2027,

down from the average of 3.5 per cent observed in 2024-25 and broadly unchanged on a cumulative basis compared with the forecasts in the April 2026 WEO,” it said.

The modest slowdown reflects the effects of the war in West Asia being partly offset by accelerated demand-driven momentum in the global technology cycle thanks to advances in AI and its adoption.

Global headline inflation is expected to increase from 4.1 per cent in 2025 to 4.7 per cent in 2026 before declining to 3.9 per cent in 2027, the WEO said.

Crude impact: Re sees worst single-day fall in a month; G-Sec yields spike

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The rupee on Wednesday felt the ripple effect of hardening crude oil prices, which jumped on US President Donald Trump’s comments that the “ceasefire with Iran is over”, the US launching strikes on Iran and the latter attacking a tanker from Qatar near the Strait of Hormuz. Government security (G-Sec) yields also spiked in response to the jump in crude oil prices.

India imports almost 90 per cent of its crude oil requirements. Any increase in crude oil prices has a direct impact on import bill, inflation, fiscal deficit and balance of payments.

SHEDS 60 PAISE

The rupee saw its worst single-day drop in about a month, closing 60 paise down at 95.56 per dollar against previous close of 94.96. Intra-day, it touched a low of 95.60 per dollar.

Brent crude oil price rose more than 3 per cent and is fast heading towards the \$80 per barrel mark. The rupee had closed 44 paise stronger on Tuesday at 94.96 per dollar against the previous close of 95.40.

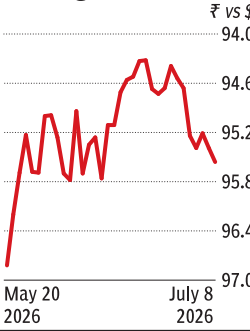
Dilip Parmar, Research Analyst, HDFC Securities, said the rupee fell the most among the Asian currencies, weighed down by a sharp rise in crude oil prices and risk-off sentiment after US President’s remarks about ending the ceasefire with Iran.

“Geopolitical concerns have lifted the risk premium amid heightened volatility. In the near term, USD-INR is expected to face resistance at 95.80 and support at 94.95, with the bias now favouring dollar bulls,” he said.

UBS India’s Chief Economist Tanvee Gupta Jain said he believes the RBI’s re-



Losing momentum



cent measures to encourage foreign currency inflows, including incentives for FCNR (B) deposits and easing of certain external borrowing norms, could attract \$50-60 billion of additional inflows and stabilise the rupee.

“That said, part of these inflows could be offset if the RBI chooses to unwind portions of its sizeable forward FX book, particularly at shorter maturities. We retain our FY27 year-end USD-INR forecast of 96, reflecting persistent headwinds (including the need to attract higher net FDI inflows, risks to IT services exports from AI-driven disruptions, and possible dollar strength should the Fed hike rates),” she said.

Meanwhile, yield of the benchmark 10-year G-Sec (6.94 per cent 2036 GS) hardened 7 bps to close at 6.76 per cent against the previous close of 6.69 per cent. Price of this security dropped 49 paise to close at ₹101.24 against the previous close of ₹101.73.



Dr. Bolla Bulli Ramaiah

Former Chairman & Managing Director, The Andhra Sugars Limited
09.07.1926 - 09.07.2026

TRIBUTES TO THE VISIONARY

The Andhra Sugars Limited has been blessed with your guidance, efficient administration and visionary leadership. The organization has made remarkable progress under your leadership. You served as a Member of Parliament for Four terms and as the Union Minister for Commerce, rendering invaluable services to the people with honesty and integrity. We fondly remember and pay our respectful tributes to **Dr. Bolla Bulli Ramaiah** on his **Birth Centenary**.



THE ANDHRA SUGARS LIMITED

TANUKU

The Andhra Petro Chemicals Limited
Visakhapatnam

Jocil Limited
Dokiparru

Jayalakshmi Fertilizers
Venkatarayapuram, Tanuku

Sri Akkamamba Textiles Limited
Venkatarayapuram, Tanuku

CM YK       M CH-CHE

QUICKLY.

Wall St falls as Trump's remarks weigh on markets



US stocks main indexes fell on Wednesday after President Donald Trump said an interim deal aimed at ending the war with Iran was “over,” while gains in Broadcom gave respite to the recently beaten-down chip stocks. Speaking at the NATO Summit, Trump said he had no interest in engaging further with Iran. Adding to tensions, he warned Iran that Washington will likely engage in additional strikes on Wednesday night. At 10:10 am ET, the Dow Jones fell 514.42 points to 52,410.73, the S&P 500 lost 34.32 points to 7,469.53 and the Nasdaq lost 78.12 points to 25,739.43. However, Philadelphia SE Semiconductor index rose 1.4 per cent. REUTERS

FPIs must pay fees only in rupees, says SEBI

Mumbai: SEBI has amended its rules replacing the existing US dollar-denominated registration fee for Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) with a rupee-based fee structure. As per the notification, the regulator has revised the registration fee for Category-I FPIs from \$2,500 to ₹2.3 lakh. Similarly, registration fee for FPIs belonging to Category II has been revised from \$250 to ₹23,000. SEBI has also revised the application fee for seeking general relaxations or exemptions from strict enforcement of regulations from \$1,000 to ₹90,000 in eligible foreign exchange equivalent. The revised provisions will come into effect after six months, SEBI said. OUR BUREAU

SEBI mulls easing FPI disclosure norms with higher exemption cap

EASE OF BIZ. Proposal aimed at relaxing one of the conditions for availing reprieve from additional disclosure

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) is examining a proposal to raise the existing 3 per cent cap on composite holdings of foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) that are eligible for exemption from making additional disclosures under the regulator's beneficial ownership framework, according to people familiar with the matter.

The proposal is aimed at providing further ease of doing business for global investors by relaxing one of the conditions for availing exemption from the additional disclosure requirements introduced in August 2023, the people said.

FPIs with over ₹50,000 crore of equity assets under

management (AUM) or those with more than 50 per cent of their Indian equity AUM concentrated in a single corporate group, are required to furnish additional granular disclosures.

INVESTOR CONCERNS

Qualifying FPIs must disclose full, look-through details of all entities and individuals holding ownership, economic interest, or control rights up to the level of natural persons. However, SEBI carved out an exemption in March 2024 for FPIs investing in promoter-less corporate groups, subject to certain conditions, including that the combined holdings of all such exempt FPIs in the apex company do not exceed 3 per cent of its total equity share capital.

FPIs have said the 3 per cent threshold is relatively



STICKY POINT. FPIs have said that the current 3% threshold is relatively low for large, widely held companies with significant passive foreign ownership and have sought relaxation

low for large, widely held companies with significant passive foreign ownership. The limit can be exhausted quickly, forcing otherwise diversified institutional investors to either rebalance their portfolios or furnish additional disclosures.

An email sent to SEBI for comments did not elicit a response. According to the sources, the proposal would enable a larger pool of genu-

ine institutional investors, particularly passive funds and long-only investors, to continue availing the exemption while retaining safeguards against misuse of the FPI route. The proposal is understood to be part of the regulator's broader effort to fine-tune the additional disclosure framework based on implementation experience and feedback received from custodians and foreign in-

Oman India Fertiliser zooms 23% on debut

Bloomberg

Oman India Fertiliser Co jumped more than 23 per cent on its Muscat trading debut after raising 261 million Omani rials (\$678 million) in the region's largest initial public offering of the year.

Shares in the fertilizer producer closed at 192 baisa on Wednesday, as investors piled into the stock despite global market volatility after President Donald Trump thrust geopolitical risks back into focus by declaring the ceasefire between the US and Iran to be over.

State-owned energy company OQ owns 50 per cent of

In the Muscat-listed company, Indian agricultural co-operatives IFFCO and Kribhco hold 25% each

Oman India Fertiliser Co, while Indian agricultural co-operatives IFFCO and Kribhco each hold 25 per cent.

The company operates ammonia and urea plants in Oman and generated \$207.4 million of revenue in the three months through March, with an EBITDA margin of 50.5 per cent.

Muscat's benchmark index closed about 1 per cent

higher, outperforming other regional bourses that ended the day in the red.

STRONG DEMAND

The firm listed at 156 baisa, the top end of a marketed range that valued the company at 1.04 billion Omani rials. The fertilizer producer drew about \$12 billion in orders, a much higher over-subscription rate than in recent major Omani listings. That included demand from prominent regional sovereign wealth funds, Bloomberg News has reported.

The offering comes as regional equity capital markets contend with a slowdown that began before the US-Iran war. Still, bankers say

some Gulf firms are getting ready to go public after the summer, with deals across Saudi Arabia, the UAE, Kuwait and Qatar raising hopes of a rebound.

Oman has been less affected by the conflict than some neighbouring Gulf states.

The IPO is the latest step in Oman's push to privatise state assets and deepen its capital markets, with OQ leading the effort.

“This year there are no plans for further IPOs,” OQ Group Chief Executive Officer Ashraf Al Mamari told Bloomberg News in Muscat.

“We are still discussing with our board if there will be any plans for 2027.”

SBI Mutual Fund to launch IPO on July 14

Our Bureau
Mumbai

State Bank of India has announced that the initial public offering of its subsidiary SBI Mutual Fund will open for retail investors subscription on July 14 and close on July 16. Allotment to investors after bidding is expected to be made on July 18. The anchor investor bidding will open on Monday.

The fund house will announce the price band on Thursday. SBI Funds Management is a joint venture between SBI and partner French asset management

F&O on index designed for FPIs gets green signal

Bloomberg

Market regulator has approved the launch of derivatives on an index designed specifically for foreign investors.

The National Stock Exchange of India has received approval from the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) to introduce futures and options tied to the Nifty India FPI 150 Index, according to people familiar with the matter who asked not to be named discussing private information.

The gauge, launched last August, tracks 150 stocks selected based on ease of accessibility for foreign investors — something global benchmark providers such as MSCI Inc typically take into account to select their index members.

An NSE representative declined to comment, citing its pending initial public offering. SEBI didn't reply to an email seeking comment.

NSE, which reaped more than two-thirds of its revenue from derivatives in the last fiscal year, is seeking to boost its offerings ahead of its listing targeted for September. Meanwhile, India wants to lure back foreign investors after an equity slump triggered months of outflows.

RUPEE DERIVATIVES

The FPI 150 gauge already has dollar-denominated derivatives tied to it in GIFT City, an offshore venue with tax advantages, though there were no contracts outstanding as of the latest date available. The rupee contracts would be listed in Mumbai and add to the suite of futures and options NSE offers on several of its gauges, including the NSE Nifty 50 and the NSE Nifty Bank.

The proposal to launch onshore derivatives on the FPI 150 was first disclosed in the exchange's draft IPO prospectus filed with SEBI last month.

Kusumgar IPO sees strong bids on Day 1

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The initial public offering of engineered fabric manufacturer Kusumgar was fully subscribed on the first day of bidding on Thursday, ending the day with 3.45 times subscription. The ₹650-crore IPO received bids for about 3.96 crore shares against 1.15 crore shares on offer. The category for non-institutional investors was booked 7.35 times, while the retail quota was subscribed 3.52 times and QIBs 47 per cent. The price band has been fixed as ₹398-419.

Knack Packaging ends Day 1 at ₹182.98, up 7.6% over IPO price

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Knack Packaging shares made a strong stock market debut on Wednesday, listing at a premium over their issue price after the company's initial public offering saw robust investor participation.

The stock settled with 7.6 per cent gains at ₹182.98 on the NSE, and at ₹182.70 on the BSE (up 7.47 per cent above the offer price of ₹170). It debuted on the NSE at ₹188, a premium of 10.5 per cent. On the BSE, the shares were listed at ₹186, a premium of 9.4 per cent.

According to Shivani Nyati, Head of Wealth at Swastika Investmart, the company is supported by healthy revenue growth, improving profitability, high return on equity and return on capital employed, robust operating margins and integrated manufacturing capabilities.

However, she flagged customer concentration risk and execution of the new manufacturing facility as key factors to watch. Nyati main-



PREMIUM SHOW. Krishnan Iyer (left), Senior Vice-President, NSE, with Alpesh Patel, Chairman & MD, Knack Packaging, at the listing ceremony

tained a positive view post-listing, recommending investors who received allotment to hold the stock for potential upside with a stop-loss at ₹175.

STRONG RESPONSE

The ₹439.5-crore IPO was subscribed 83.33 times overall. The qualified institutional buyers category was subscribed 154.34 times, non-institutional investors 139.81 times and retail investors quota 20.07 times.

The company had raised ₹131.25 crore from anchor

investors ahead of the issue opening for subscription.

The public issue comprised a fresh issue of equity shares aggregating up to ₹380 crore and an offer-for-sale of up to 35 lakh equity shares worth ₹59.5 crore by existing shareholders.

Knack Packaging said proceeds from the fresh issue will be used for setting up a new manufacturing facility at Borisana, Kadi, in Gujarat's Mehsana district, while the remaining funds will be utilised for general corporate purposes.

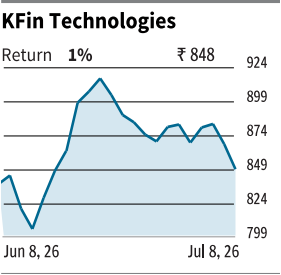
KFin to okay SIP request the same day

Our Bureau
Mumbai

KFin Technologies on Wednesday announced that its Finex transformation programme has raised same-day physical SIP (Systematic Investment Plan) registration rates from 15 per cent to 90 per cent, sharply compressing what has historically been a 21-30-day onboarding cycle for mutual fund investors.

The Mumbai-headquartered company said the platform, built entirely in-house by a team of over 250 engineers and domain experts, replaces the conventional sequential processing model with a parallel digital pipeline.

Key components include AI-powered OCR/ICR document capture, agentic excep-



tion processing that autonomously resolves routine payment gateway variances, real-time KYC and banking credential validation, and automated inter-departmental workflow routing.

Beyond same-day activation, KFin Tech said fresh mandate set up within seven days improved from 65 per cent to 90 per cent, reaching 99 per cent on fully optimised tracks.

The system has also

achieved 100 per cent exception tracking, meaning every registration that encounters a network failure can now be monitored and corrected end-to-end.

Praveen Shankaran, Chief Operating Officer for Domestic Fund Services, KFinTech, said the programme converts what was previously a multi-week administrative process into a same-day investor experience, which he described as a step toward a more responsive, investor-centric MF ecosystem.

KFinTech is India's largest investor solutions provider to mutual funds by number of AMCs serviced as of March 2026.

The stock is down roughly 32 per cent over the past year against a 1.3 per cent decline in the Nifty 500 over the same period.

BROKER'S CALL.

Motilal Oswal Research

MARICO (BUY)

Target: ₹1,000
CMP: ₹840.15
Marico delivered a strong performance in FY26, with 26 per cent revenue growth and 11 per cent APAT growth, outperforming FMCG peers. The management commentary remains positive for FY27, with guidance of high-single-digit volume growth in India, double-digit consolidated revenue growth and high-teen EBITDA growth. In India, Parachute is entering the volume recovery mode as copra prices have corrected about 45 per cent from the peak and the company has already reduced prices by 15-20 per cent, which supported double-digit volume growth in Q1FY27. Value-added hair oils remained the standout performer, delivering about 20 per cent growth in FY26, and is expected to sustain over 20 per cent growth in Q1FY27. In Saffola oils, the company focuses on profitability. Marico expects its India business to deliver double-digit volume growth and more than 20 per cent revenue growth in Q1FY27. Marico's digital-first portfolio is expected to achieve double-digit EBITDA margins by FY27 end, which should expand further to the teens by FY30. In international business, Bangladesh's share has declined from about 50 per cent in FY20 to about 45 per cent in FY26 and is expected to fall further to 35 per cent by FY30, indicating diversification across other markets. We model a CAGR of 13 per cent/21 per cent/18 per cent in revenue/EBITDA/APAT over FY26-28. We maintain our Buy rating with a TP of ₹1,000 (50x P/E on FY28).

Monarch Network Capital

MINDA CORP (BUY)

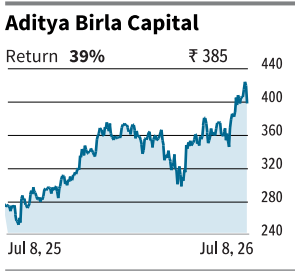
Target: ₹825
CMP: ₹684
Minda Corp is structurally positioned to outperform the auto ancillary space, riding four powerful tailwinds simultaneously for market share expansion — premiumisation, EV transition, localisation and export scale-up. The shift from analogue to TFT clusters (8x ASP uplift) and increase in high-voltage wiring harnesses are expected to be key triggers for content per vehicle growth. Beyond electronics, Minda is simultaneously scaling exports, adjacent product categories and order-backed capacities. Despite gradual premiumisation, vehicle access continues to provide stable and margin-accretive growth supported by ASEAN exports. Flash Electronics and Turntide agreements would not only catapult 2W EV kit value by 3x versus ICE 2W but also mark Minda's entry into high power motor controllers. With a large order backlog of ₹1,000 crore comprising new products like sunroofs and switches (Toyodeno JV) and existing products (die casting for EV) further diversify the growth algorithm. We expect Minda to deliver 19 per cent/20 per cent/28 per cent Revenue/EBITDA/PAT CAGR over FY26-28E. Therefore, we value Minda at a premium multiple of 34x FY28E EPS to arrive at a TP of ₹825 and initiate coverage with a Buy rating, reflecting the company's increasing electronics mix, diversified growth architecture and improving earnings quality. Key risks include slower TFT adoption, weaker underlying industry growth, delays in utilisation ramp-up, slower localisation progress and export execution risks.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

TODAY'S PICK.

Aditya Birla Capital (₹385.50): BUY

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau



The short-term picture looks bullish for Aditya Birla Capital despite the sharp fall on Wednesday. The 4.9 per cent fall on Wednesday has brought the share price close to a key support level of ₹377.

We expect the stock to reverse higher from this support. That leg of the rise can take Aditya Birla Capital's share price to ₹425-₹430 in the coming weeks.

Traders can buy Aditya Birla Capital shares at ₹385 now. Accumulate on dips at ₹379. Keep the stop-loss at ₹364. Trail the stop-loss up to ₹391 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹397.

Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹398 and ₹410 when the price touches ₹406 and ₹417, respectively. Exit the long positions at ₹425. If the price breaks ₹377 and declines, then adhere to the stop-loss and exit. Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis. There is a risk of loss in trading

Day trading guide

23893 » Nifty 50 Futures

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
23800	23630	24080	24160	Take fresh shorts below 23800. Keep the stop-loss at 23830

₹809 » HDFC Bank

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
806	800	815	825	Take fresh shorts below 806. Keep the stop-loss at 808

₹1069 » Infosys

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1060	1050	1090	1115	Wait for dips. Go long at 1063. Keep the stop-loss at 1055

₹281 » ITC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
277	275	284	286	Go short now and at 283. Stop-loss can be kept at 285

₹247 » ONGC

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
245	241	250	254	Go long only above 250. Stop-loss can be placed at 248

₹1275 » Reliance Ind.

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1255	1235	1290	1315	Go short now and at 1285. Keep the stop-loss at 1295

₹1019 » SBI

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
1010	990	1030	1045	Go short only below 1010. Keep the stop-loss at 1015

₹2060 » TCS

S1	S2	R1	R2	COMMENT
2035	1980	2090	2120	Go long on a bounce from 2035. Keep the stop-loss at 2025

S1, S2: Support 1 & 2; R1, R2: Resistance 1 & 2.

Nifty 50 Movers ▼ 516.65 pts.					
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
ONGC	247.00	2.39	6.24	0.88	
Bajaj Auto	10164.00	1.32	26.86	1.03	
Hindalco	971.65	0.68	16.31	1.29	
Coal India	429.05	0.05	8.51	0.54	
Wipro	172.72	-0.18	13.68	0.45	
Trent Ltd.	2924.00	-0.28	90.58	0.89	
Dr Reddys Lab	1349.00	-0.75	27.08	0.75	
Titan	4586.40	-1.61	80.25	1.73	
Apollo Hosp	8753.50	-1.88	62.85	0.82	
Infosys	1069.30	-1.92	14.72	2.43	
Cipla	1431.80	-2.46	29.95	0.74	
Tech Mahindra	1428.80	-2.59	29.14	0.83	
Tata Steel	188.20	-2.87	21.58	1.42	
NestleIndia	1450.50	-3.34	79.94	0.95	
Sun Pharma	1888.20	-3.52	39.37	1.83	
Eicher Motors	7418.50	-3.54	36.92	0.93	
Adani Enter	3046.90	-3.80	39.83	0.80	
Bajaj Finserv	1854.90	-3.84	15.09	0.98	
HDFC Life	555.70	-3.94	62.71	0.55	
SBI Life	1789.00	-4.25	72.65	0.74	
Eternal Ltd.	286.70	-4.26	755.94	1.90	
PowerGrid Corp	279.70	-4.60	16.33	1.16	
Greaves Ind.	3134.80	-4.62	20.71	1.06	
Tata Motors PV	332.05	-4.68	4076.28	0.63	
TataConsumerProduct	1089.80	-5.01	69.73	0.65	
HCL Tech	1145.60	-5.20	18.67	1.10	
Max Healthcare	1004.80	-5.46	73.20	0.74	
JSW Steel	1219.50	-5.51	11.69	1.05	
WIPAC	948.70	-5.69	12.27	1.51	
Asian Paints	2665.90	-6.47	58.19	1.10	
Adani Ports	1791.70	-6.80	32.30	1.21	
UltraTech Cement	11353.00	-7.65	40.86	1.23	
TCS	2057.50	-8.61	15.05	1.92	
Bharat Elec	407.60	-9.04	49.15	1.34	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	229.99	-9.37	97.29	0.69	
IndigoLabs	5124.00	-15.09	31.00	1.06	
Hind Unilever	2135.80	-14.14	47.42	1.73	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	1014.40	-16.03	23.81	1.30	
Maruti Suzuki	13951.00	-16.72	29.88	1.66	
ITC	280.65	-17.05	16.73	2.47	
MM	3102.50	-18.31	20.72	2.53	
Kotak Bank	1971.00	-21.20	19.09	2.49	
Bajaj Finance	1010.40	-18.79	32.54	2.46	
State Bank	1016.90	-19.14	10.83	3.84	
Axis Bank	1309.50	-19.76	15.34	3.45	
Bharti Airtel	1888.10	-25.04	34.01	5.25	
L&T	3892.10	-25.51	28.25	4.17	
Reliance Ind	1275.90	-47.55	18.03	7.88	
ICICI Bank	1380.90	-53.35	17.09	9.04	
HDFC Bank	810.30	-63.55	15.75	11.35	

Pts: Impact on index movement					
Nifty Next 50 Movers				▼ 1,349.70 pts.	
	Close(%)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Cummins India	5498.50	10.69	64.54	3.07	
Macrotech Developers .	1115.10	10.20	32.47	1.28	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1655.50	4.33	83.11	2.86	
Torrent Power	4866.40	9.28	77.04	2.11	
Hindus Zinc	530.30	-1.13	16.20	1.05	
Siemens Energy India .	3358.70	-2.64	91.32	1.23	
ZyodentSolutions	1148.00	-3.67	22.55	1.19	
CG Power & In Sol	808.48	-4.82	119.51	2.57	
GTCL	675.00	-6.15	68.83	3.55	
Bosch	41610.00	-8.26	44.25	1.49	
Magnum	346.25	-3.97	30.05	0.72	
Siemens	1246.10	-12.67	80.06	1.26	
MuthootFin	3083.30	-12.95	11.67	1.37	
Vedanta	372.30	-13.67	6.71	1.91	
AdaniEnergy	1504.40	-14.15	124.73	2.09	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	87.50	-12.27	16.31	0.73	
Jindal Steel	1021.50	-15.09	31.00	1.56	
Avenuesuper	403.68	-15.25	88.69	2.69	
Mazagon Dock	2450.70	-16.14	35.88	0.67	
Uminirex	177.50	-17.56	22.59	1.46	
Adani Power .	216.48	-19.34	32.19	3.71	
HindustanAeronautics	4364.70	-19.79	32.02	3.42	
Solar Industries	17971.00	-21.20	93.64	1.81	
Tata Power	371.20	-24.93	23.23	2.57	
Godrej Consumer	1075.20	-26.51	59.10	1.79	
Amara Raja	1494.00	-26.49	54.68	1.73	
Hyundai Motor India .	1916.90	-26.58	28.83	1.12	
Ambuja Cements	421.10	-27.04	19.04	1.09	
Rural Elec	348.75	-27.45	5.63	1.80	
Punjab Nat Bank	100.95	-28.67	6.28	1.44	
Shree Cement	25910.00	-31.36	53.46	1.43	
Alco India	677.10	-31.76	50.81	1.47	
DFC	634.00	-32.15	35.55	1.68	
SamvardhanaSternInternatnl	140.65	-35.22	36.33	2.57	
Gail (India)	169.24	-37.71	14.68	1.89	
Union Bank	154.39	-38.89	6.01	1.23	
Carbor Oolink	17.15	-38.22	6.15	1.68	
Venar Beverages	47.45	-37.87	50.00	2.68	
Bank Of Baroda	240.45	-40.24	6.20	1.84	
Power Finance	403.60	-40.75	3.96	2.43	
Britannia Ind	5315.50	-45.40	50.47	2.59	
Pidilint	1570.40	-47.13	64.69	2.01	
Indrapol	137.63	-49.82	6.46	2.51	
Tvs Motor Corp	3639.70	-50.26	54.27	3.53	
Tata Motors Cv	416.75	-50.02	40.68	3.60	
Bajaj Holdings	10336.00	-53.68	11.75	1.85	
Indian Hotels Co .	72.90	-59.32	45.79	2.62	
Bpl	303.55	-61.77	51.00	2.54	
Hero Cycles	2659.20	-74.21	39.88	3.48	
Chandam&JamInFin	1769.40	-106.50	28.83	3.16	
Pts: Impact on index movement					

QUICKLY.

NPCI seeks nod to set up
techfin unit at GIFT City

Ahmedabad: The National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI) has applied to establish a 'techfin' unit at Gujarat International Finance Tec-City (GIFT City). The move adds to the growing list of tech firms setting up operations in India's only International Financial Services Centre (IFSC), reinforcing GIFT City's emergence as a global hub for fintech services. NPCI plans to establish the unit on the 18th floor of the IFSC Authority headquarters building within GIFT City's SEZ. **OUR BUREAU**

RBI nod for Mahesh Pai as South Indian Bank CEO

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India has approved the appointment of Mahesh Muralidhar Pai as MD & CEO of South Indian Bank for three years with effect from October 1. The bank, in a regulatory filing, said an agenda for Pai's appointment will be placed at the Board meeting scheduled for July 16. The approval of the shareholders shall be obtained thereafter in this regard as per the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and SEBI Listing Regulations. **OUR BUREAU**

ISMA defends E20 petrol, says social media claims lack scientific backing

IN DEFENCE. Sugar industry body insists E20 fuel rollout followed rigorous testing and scientific evaluation

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Indian Sugar and Bio-Energy Manufacturers' Association (ISMA) has dismissed public concerns over E20 ethanol-blended petrol, saying the ongoing public discourse should be guided by scientific evidence, verified data and official clarifications, rather than misinformation circulating on social media.

Of late, there has been growing concern over a drop in mileage attributed to the adoption of E20 fuel.

While automakers claim it to be marginal, at around 3-3.5 per cent, many consumers allege it is higher at 20-30 per cent. A social media user on X said: "Hybrid system is inherently highly efficient, boasting an official fuel economy of 23.24 kmpl.

However, because ethanol delivers lower thermal energy per litre than pure petrol, real-world E20 mileage drops to around 16-18 kmpl



ROAD RAGE. People shared on social media that their vehicles' mileage reduced after switching to E20

depending on driving conditions." Several people have shared on social media that their vehicles' mileage reduced 2-3 km (20-30 per cent) after switching to E20.

KEJRIWAL RAISES ISSUE
Former Delhi Chief Minister and AAP National Convenor Arvind Kejriwal on Wednesday wrote to 29 automobile manufacturers, seeking clarification on the impact of E20 fuel on vehicle mileage and performance, and requested them to respond within seven days. Sharing

his letter with Toyota Kirloskar Motor's Vikram Gulati, Kejriwal asked whether the company would compensate users of pre-2023, non-E20-compliant vehicles if the mileage drops more than 10 per cent after using E20 fuel.

In a statement on Wednesday, ISMA said that according to the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, India's Ethanol Blending with Petrol Programme is scientifically validated, rigorously tested and continuously monitored in consultation with oil marketing

companies (OMCs), automakers, fuel testing agencies, and other stakeholders.

FACT CHECK
"The government said there have been no incidents of engine failure or vehicle breakdown linked to E20 petrol since its rollout.

The Ministry said that fuel-grade ethanol is produced through industrial processes such as fermentation and distillation and does not resemble its original agricultural feedstock. It is made from multiple

sources, including sugarcane juice, molasses, broken rice and maize, and must meet fuel-quality standards before being blended with petrol, ISMA said. Highlighting the recent press briefing by select automobile manufacturers, ISMA said the automakers, OMCs, Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers, Federation of Indian Petroleum Industry and the Automotive Research Association of India have publicly defended E20, saying concerns about vehicle breakdowns stem from "hearsay, misinformation and misunderstanding".

Industry representatives said any mileage variation, where observed, was marginal, while E20 helps cut emissions, reduce oil imports, save forex and support farmer incomes. "India's ethanol programme is one of the most successful examples of aligning energy security, farmer welfare and cleaner mobility," said ISMA Director General Deepak Ballani in the statement.

Sun Mobility to launch battery-swapping platform for e-trucks

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Bengaluru-based Sun Mobility is making its biggest push yet into the commercial electric vehicle (EV) market with the launch of what it describes as the world's first modular battery-swapping platform for electric trucks and buses across the 3-tonne to 55-tonne segment. It plans to showcase the product, developed and demonstrated with the Tata Motors' Starbus 12m EV.

Backed by a \$78-million (about ₹650 crore) investment through its IndoFast Swap Energy joint venture with Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL), the platform will make its public debut at Pravaas 5.0 in Gandhinagar from July 9 to 11. If adopted

by multiple manufacturers, the OEM-agnostic battery architecture could create a common energy infrastructure for commercial EVs, replacing proprietary battery ecosystems with a shared swapping network.

"We are not accelerating the transition to electric mobility. We are eliminating the barriers that slowed it down with the world's first modular multi-battery swapping technology," said Chetan Maini, Co-founder and Chairman of Sun Mobility, ahead of the launch.

PLATFORM STRATEGY
The platform received AIS-038 certification from the Automotive Research Association of India in March, becoming the first indigenously-developed high-voltage swappable battery

The platform received AIS-038 certification from the Automotive Research Association of India in March

platform for trucks and buses.

The platform supports 330-volt and 660-volt electrical architectures. It uses modular 50 kWh and 100 kWh battery packs that can be automatically swapped in under three minutes.

BATTERY ECONOMICS
Sun Mobility is targeting one of the biggest hurdles to commercial vehicle electrification: battery economics. Electric buses and trucks

typically use fixed battery packs of 200-400 kWh, increasing vehicle acquisition costs while reducing payload because of battery weight. Charging these vehicles can take between 90 minutes and four hours, lowering fleet utilisation for operators whose revenues depend on keeping vehicles on the road.

The opportunity is significant because private operators own nearly 90 per cent of the commercial buses and trucks, making operating economics and vehicle uptime critical to EV adoption.

BAA5 MODEL
Sun Mobility's Battery-as-a-Service (BaaS) model separates battery ownership from the vehicle. Fleet operators purchase the vehicle while paying only for the energy consumed. According to the

company, the model reduces the upfront acquisition cost of an electric bus or truck by about 40 per cent, bringing prices closer to comparable diesel and CNG vehicles. Operators can optimise payload by carrying only the battery modules required for a particular route instead of oversized fixed battery packs.

IndoFast Swap Energy will establish automated battery-swapping stations across IOCL's fuel retail network, while Sun Mobility supplies the battery technology, swapping systems and manufacturing. The initial rollout will focus on high-density freight corridors and intercity bus routes, allowing operators to swap batteries at highway locations instead of investing in dedicated charging depots.

Tilaknagar Ind posts record 3.4 m sales in June

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tilaknagar Industries Ltd reported its highest-ever monthly sales volume of 3.4 million cases of liquor, driven by strong performance from Imperial Blue Whisky and Mansion House Brandy, on Wednesday.

The record comes after back-to-back strong months, and combined business volumes also crossed 3 million cases in May 2026. Imperial Blue Whisky crossed 2 million cases in May and June, recovering from minor disruptions the company flagged in April.

Chief Sales Officer Nishant Jain attributed the performance to execution capabilities and distribution strength, noting that the company has expanded market share in strategic regions even as integration of Imperial Blue continues. The company holds the third-largest position in the Prestige & Above spirits segment nationally and commands roughly 40 per cent market share across South India, excluding Tamil Nadu. Imperial Blue also recorded double-digit sequential growth in North India.

On the premiumisation front, Tilaknagar expanded its 'House of T' luxury portfolio into West Bengal, launching Seven Islands Pure Malt Whisky, Monarch Legacy Edition Brandy and two Samsara gin variants. The Samsara products are launched under a usership agreement with Spaceman Spirits Lab, in which Tilaknagar holds a 21.36 per cent stake. The company plans to roll out these premium brands across other key markets soon.

Food Processing Ministry holds talks on next phase of PLI scheme

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Food Processing Industries (MoFPI) on Wednesday held a high-level stakeholder consultation to deliberate on the future roadmap for fiscal support to the food processing sector and to formulate the next phase of the incentive and subsidy schemes, said an official statement.

In his address, Avinash Joshi, Secretary, Ministry of Food Processing Industries, emphasised that the government is committed to building an "evidence-based, industry-driven framework for the next generation of food processing incentives".

He stated that the future policy architecture will focus



Industry players highlighted the need to strengthen support for overseas branding and marketing

on strengthening domestic manufacturing, enhancing India's global competitiveness, promoting innovation and technology adoption, encouraging value addition and ensuring greater benefits for farmers, MSMEs and agri-value chains.

Senior officials of the Ministry, representatives of IFCI

Ltd, Invest India, industry leaders, sectoral associations and beneficiaries of the PLISFPI scheme, participated in the consultation.

"The objective was to obtain structured industry feedback on the design, scope, implementation framework and incentive architecture for the proposed expansion of the scheme," the Ministry noted.

PLI SCHEME
Under the ongoing PLI scheme, beneficiary companies have surpassed initial commitments by 20 per cent, with investments exceeding ₹9,207 crore across 212 manufacturing locations in 22 States against the committed investment of ₹7,722 crore. "Sales of PLI-supported products have grown at a

CAGR of 10.82 per cent, increasing from ₹58,758 crore in FY20 to ₹1,08,854 crore in FY26, while exports registered a CAGR of 11.05 per cent, reaching ₹20,840 crore during the same period," the Ministry noted.

"Sector-specific deliberations were held across major food processing segments, including ready-to-cook/ready-to-eat foods, bakery and confectionery, processed fruits & vegetables, beverages and spices, marine products, dairy, nutraceuticals, functional foods, plant-based proteins, animal feed and food processing machinery," it added.

INDUSTRY'S WISH
Industry representatives recommended that the next phase should adopt a more

flexible and outcome-oriented incentive framework. Suggestions included broadening the coverage of the scheme to encompass emerging food categories, introducing differentiated incentive structures based on objectives such as exports, import substitution, research and development, innovation and technology adoption and linking incentives with employment generation and capital investment.

They highlighted the need to strengthen support for overseas branding and marketing, improve reimbursement mechanisms, facilitate backward integration for critical raw materials, simplify processes, rationalise eligibility criteria and encourage automation and quality enhancement.



AMARA RAJA | ELECTRONICS

AMARA RAJA ELECTRONICS LIMITED

CIN: U31402AP1999PLC032257

Regd. Office: Renigunta - Cuddapah Road, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh, India, 517520.

Form No. INC – 25A

ADVERTISEMENT TO BE PUBLISHED IN THE NEWSPAPER FOR CONVERSION OF PUBLIC COMPANY INTO A PRIVATE COMPANY

Before the Regional Director, Ministry of Corporate Affairs Southern Region

In the matter of the Companies Act, 2013, Section 14 of Companies Act, 2013 and Rule 41 of the Companies (Incorporation) Rules, 2014

AND

In the matter of M/s. Amara Raja Electronics Limited having its registered office at Renigunta - Cuddapah Road, Karakambadi, Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh, India, 517520- Applicant.

Notice is hereby given to the general public that the Company intending to make an application to the Central Government under Section 14 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with aforesaid rules and is desirous of converting into a private limited company in terms of the special resolution passed at the Extra-Ordinary Meeting held on June 24, 2026 to enable the Company to give effect for such conversion.

Any person whose interest is likely to be affected by the proposed change/status of the Company may deliver or cause to be delivered or send by registered post of his objections supported by an affidavit stating the nature of his interest and grounds of opposition to the Regional Director, Southern Region, 5th Floor, Shastri Bhawan, 26 Haddows Road, Chennai – 600006 , within fourteen days from the date of publication of this notice with a copy to the applicant company at its registered office at the address mentioned below:

Amara Raja Electronics Limited
Renigunta - Cuddapah Road Karakambadi,
Tirupati, Andhra Pradesh, India, 517520

Place: Hyderabad
Date: July 9, 2026

For Amara Raja Electronics Limited

Sd/-
Vikramadithya Gourineni
DIN: 03167659 | Director



Corporate Contracts Department)

Sahar Receiving Station, Near Hotel Leela, Andheri (E), Mumbai 400 059, Maharashtra, India
(Board Line: 022-67173188) CIN: L28920MH1919PLC000567

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Tata Power Company Limited hereby invites Expression of Interest from eligible parties for the following packages:

OUTLINE AGREEMENT FOR THE SUPPLY OF T-SHIRTS (PAN INDIA) FOR ONE YEAR (Package Ref. No.: CC27SR017)

For package: Eligible parties willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee on or before **20th July 2026.**

For details of pre-qualification requirements, purchasing of tender document, bid security, tender documents etc., please visit Tender section of our website (**U R L: https://www.tatapower.com/tender/tenders-listing**).

ERNAKULAM REGIONAL CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.
EDAPPALLY, KOCHI-24 Ph: 0484-2541193
e-mail: ercmpupur@milma.com

TENDER NOTICE 07.07.2026

Title	Tender Id	Bid Closing
E-Tender for Supply of Biomass Briquette (Pre Bid meeting :14.07.2026 11.00 AM	2026_KCMFMF_859591_1	22.07.26 04.30 PM
Re E-Tender for Recertification & Surveillance Audit of ISO Standards	2026_KCMFMF_856869_2	15.07.26 03.30 PM
Re E-Tender for Supply of 40 Litre Plastic Milk Can under ERCMPU ltd	2026_KCMFMF_856666_2	17.07.26 04.00 PM

For details, please visit **ERCMPU Head Office, Edappally.** (Sd/-) Managing Director

B2B e-comm firm Udaan to sign recapitalisation deal

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Business-to-business (B2B) e-commerce unicorn Udaan is set to sign a comprehensive recapitalisation agreement soon after reaching a broad consensus on the terms with all key stakeholders, including the company, its major existing shareholders, a majority of bondholders and a new investor, people familiar with the matter told *businessline*.

"The detailed recapitalisation terms have now been agreed upon by all the key stakeholders. The definitive agreement is expected to be signed this week or early next week," a person aware of the discussions said.

According to sources, the transaction is expected to strengthen the company's balance sheet while resolving complexities arising from its existing debt structure.

"The transaction will materially improve the company's financial position, simplify the capital structure and support its longer-term IPO ambitions," another person said.

The development comes even as some Udaan global creditors initiated insolvency proceedings against Trustroost Internet Pte Ltd, the company's Singapore-based holding entity, after it defaulted on \$170 million of compulsory convertible notes that matured on June 30.



Powering the world responsibly

SWELECT ENERGY SYSTEMS LIMITED
Corporate Identity Number: L93090TN1994PLC028578
Registered Office : 'SWELECT HOUSE',
No.5, Sir P.S. Sivasamy Salai, Mylapore, Chennai - 600 004.
Tel. : +91 44 24993266. Fax : +91 44 24995179.
E-mail : cg.ird@swelectes.com Website : www.swelectes.com

Notice of 31st Annual General Meeting, E-Voting, Book Closure and Record Date

Notice is hereby given that the **31st (Thirty First) Annual General Meeting (AGM)** of the Members of the Company is scheduled to be held on **Friday, the 31st July, 2026 at 03:30 P.M. (IST)** through Video Conferencing (VC) facility/ Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM) provided by M/s. Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL), to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice of AGM dated 21st May, 2026 and addendum Notice dated 6th July, 2026 in accordance with the Circular No.03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 (in continuation with the Circulars issued earlier in this regard) ("MCA Circulars") and in compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 ("Act"), MCA Circulars, SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (Listing Regulations) and the relevant circulars issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI).

In compliance with the aforesaid MCA and SEBI Circulars, the Company has sent the Notice of the 31st AGM, addendum to the Notice of the AGM and Annual Report for the Financial Year 2025-2026 electronically on **8th July, 2026**, only to those Members whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company / Registrar & Transfer Agent ("Registrar"/ Depositories. In addition, a letter was sent to those members whose email addresses are not registered with the Company/RTA/DP, providing the weblink where the Annual Report can be accessed on the Company's website. A physical copy of the Annual Report for financial year 2025-2026 together with the abovesaid notice will be sent to the members who have requested for the same at **cg.ird@swelectes.com** mentioning their Folio No./DP ID and Client ID.

Any person, who acquires shares of the Company and becomes member after sending email of the above notice and Annual Report and holding shares as on the Record date i.e. 24th July 2026, may obtain the abovesaid Notice together with the Annual Report 2025-2026 by sending email request to the Company from their registered email id and shall follow the detailed procedure for remote E-voting, which is provided in the Notice of the meeting. The Notice and Annual Report 2025-2026 are available on the website of the Company (**www.swelectes.com**) under the following web links.

Annual Report:
https://swelectes.com/pdf/financial-information/annual-report/2025-2026/SESL%20AR%2025-26_Website.pdf
AGM Notice and Addendum Notice:
https://swelectes.com/pdf/meeting-information/aggm/2026/SESL%2031%20AGM%20Notice_Website.pdf

The Annual Report and AGM Notice and Addendum Notice will also be made available on the website of stock exchanges (**www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**) and CDSL's website (**www.evotingindia.com**). If the member is already registered with CDSL for remote e-voting then they can use their existing User ID and password for casting the vote through remote e-voting.

Members holding shares in physical form and who have not yet registered their e-mail addresses are requested to access the following web link **https://investors.cameoindia.com**, for registering their e-mail and addresses to receive the notice and report. Members holding shares in electronic mode are requested to update their email ids and mobile numbers with the Depository Participants ("DPs") where they hold their Demat account.

Register of Members will be closed from **25th July, 2026 to 31st July, 2026 (Both days inclusive)** for the purpose of 31st AGM & Final Dividend, which is subject to approval of members at the 31st AGM. The record date for AGM and Final Dividend is fixed on **Friday, 24th July, 2026.**

The Company has engaged the services of CDSL to provide the e-voting facility to its members whose names appear in the Register of Members/ Beneficial owners as on the Record date i.e. **24th July, 2026** to exercise their right to vote by remote e-voting and e-voting at the AGM on the businesses specified in the above Notices for convening the 31st (Thirty First) Annual General Meeting of the Company.

The remote e-voting facility will be available during the following period.

Commencing from : 09:00 Hours (IST) on 28th July, 2026
Ending on : 17:00 Hours (IST) on 30th July, 2026

Remote e-voting shall not be allowed after 17:00 Hours (IST) on 30th July, 2026 and the remote e-voting facility would be blocked.

The facility for remote e-voting system shall also be made available during the Meeting and the Members attending the Meeting, who have not already cast their vote by remote e-voting shall be able to cast their vote during the Meeting.

The voting rights of members shall be in proportion to their shares held in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the record date being **24th July, 2026**. A person, whose name is recorded in the register of members or in the register of beneficial owners maintained by the depositories as on the record date shall be entitled to avail the facility of remote e-voting as well as e-voting at the AGM. The members who have cast their vote by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may attend the AGM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again. Once the vote on a resolution has been cast by the Member, he/she shall not be allowed to change it subsequently or cast the vote again.

Mr.P. Eswaramoorthy, Proprietor, M/s. P. Eswaramoorthy and Company, Company Secretaries (Membership No. FCS 6510) has been appointed as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the remote e-Voting before/during the AGM in a fair and transparent manner.

Pursuant to Finance Act 2020, dividend income will be taxable at the hands of shareholders w.e.f. April 1, 2020. For the prescribed rates for various categories, the shareholders are requested to refer to the Income Tax Act, 2025 and amendments thereof.

In case of any queries/ grievances regarding e-voting, members may contact Mr.Rakesh Dalvi, Sr. Manager, Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL), A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futurex, Mafatlal Mill Compounds, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai – 400013 or send an email to **helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com** or call toll free no.1800 210999 11 or may also contact Company's Registrar and Share Transfer Agent M/s.Cameo Corporate Services Limited, Subramanian Building, No.1, Club House Road, Chennai - 600 002. Name of contact person: Ms.Rani Kannan, Assistant Manager and website for investors' grievances: **https://wisdom.cameoindia.com/** Phone: +91-44-28460390, Fax: +91-44-28460129. Members may also refer the Frequently Asked Questions ("FAQs") and e-voting manual available at **https://www.evotingindia.com** under help section.

By order of the Board
for **SWELECT ENERGY SYSTEMS LIMITED**

Sd/-
J Bhuvaneshwari
Company Secretary
Membership No.A25193
Place : Chennai
Date : 08.07.2026

CM YK 100% CH-CE

QUICKLY.

Cocoa hits 7-month peaks on El Nino concerns

London: London cocoa futures on the ICE hit seven-month peaks on Wednesday as the market remained concerned about a strong or potentially very strong El Nino pattern wreaking climate havoc in key growing regions. Raw sugar scaled near two-month peaks, meanwhile, as oil prices rallied. London cocoa was up 7 per cent at \$4,562 a tonne at 1423 GMT. New York cocoa rose 6.6 per cent to \$6,139 a tonne. REUTERS

Gold dips after Trump says deal with Iran 'over'



Gold prices fell as inflation concerns intensified after US President Donald Trump said an interim agreement aimed at ending the conflict with Iran was “over.” Spot gold dropped 0.8 per cent to \$4,072.69 per ounce by 1310 GMT. US gold futures for August delivery slipped 1.8 per cent to \$4,083.20. Silver fell 2.42 per cent to \$58.5681, platinum shed 3.6 per cent to \$1,582.13, and palladium dipped 4.3 per cent to \$1,221.97. REUTERS

West Asian crisis sends mixed cues for metals

London: Copper slipped after fresh hostilities in West Asia threatened an interim ceasefire deal, reviving worries about economic growth and the supply of metals. Benchmark three-month copper on the LME shed 1.1 per cent to \$13,221 a tonne by 1430 GMT. Aluminium added 0.1 per cent to \$3,139, and zinc fell 0.8 per cent to \$3,543. Tin lost 1.6 per cent to \$52,515. REUTERS

‘Agri markets have not priced in fertilizer supply risks’

IRAN WAR IMPACT. High prices of crop nutrients could lead to less utilisation as China and India will likely face problems

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai

Agri-commodity markets have not fully priced in the risks caused by concerns over the rise in fertilizer prices due to the Iran war, while farmers in developing nations, besides China, face pronounced risks, say analysts. “The key concern (of not fully pricing the risks) is that higher fertilizer prices will reduce usage, which could weigh on crop yields and tighten agricultural supply over time,” said Thijs Geijer, Senior Sector Economist, Food and Agri, and Warren Patterson, Head of Commodities Strategy at ING Think, the economic and financial analysis wing of Dutch multinational financial ser-

vices firm ING. Farmers in developing countries are generally more sensitive to prices, while farmers in developed economies (including the EU) tend to have more options to mitigate the risks, the duo said. The disruption to fertilizer markets has been exacerbated by the implementation of export quotas and restrictions by other major exporters, including Russia and China, they said. **TO HIT OUTPUT** “That further exposes vulnerabilities in key importing regions like Australia, Brazil, India and the EU,” the ING strategists said. “Higher energy prices may increase fertilizer costs and reduce fertilizer application rates, potentially lowering crop yields and production,”

Prices easing but...

	June average (\$/tonne)	% month-on-month change	% year-on-year change	12-month high (\$/tonne)	12-month low (\$/tonne)
Ammonia	828.8	-3.4	+95.2	857.5	476.0
Urea	1,054.9	-34.4	+16.5	1,667.9	888.9
AmmoniumNitrate	1,637.7	-5.9	+32.9	1,741.1	1,181.1
Phosphate	1,878.3	+0.1	+17.3	1,878.3	1,397.7
Potash	634.7	+2.1	+10.5	634.7	564.7

Source: Agricultural Market Information System of FAO

said the Agricultural Marketing Information System (AMIS) of UN’s Food and Agriculture Organisation. “In our view, of the major agricultural markets, India faces the most imminent risk. China, which depends on sulphur imports from the region for phosphate fertilizer production, faces pronounced risks, though these remain manageable,” said re-search agency BMI, a unit of Fitch Solutions.

BMI does not expect a rise in fertilizer application in Asia as farm profitability remains pressured. Overall, “still-high” input costs will restrict farm production and fertilizer use, it said. **SIGNS OF EASING** Despite concerns, the Indian government is confident of meeting the demand for kharif crops during July-September. India has covered 43 per cent of its fer-

tilizer demand for the kharif season and expects domestic production to bridge the gap. AMIS said the fertilizer market showed signs of easing in June on improved flows through the Strait of Hormuz, and energy prices softened. “While fertilizer affordability has improved in some regions, it remains a constraint in others,” it said. However, Indian cereal production would decline by 2 per cent in 2026, while in Thailand it would decline by 3 per cent in 2026 and 2 per cent in 2027. “These reductions reflect lower fertilizer application in response to higher input costs,” said AMIS. BMI said that per the latest World Bank Commodity Prices, fertilizer prices eased 4.6 per cent in June overall. “Looking specifically

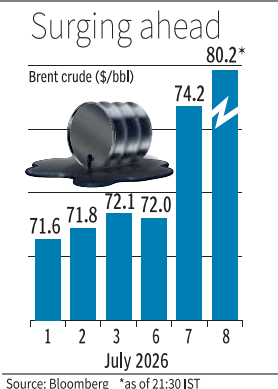
at urea, prices eased but remained elevated,” it said. AMIS said in June, fertilizer cost indicators declined across most crops and locations, apart from rice production in China. Nitrogen prices declined as supply rebounded and subdued demand outside India. Geijer and Patterson said the current geopolitical conditions are clearly negative for commodity markets. “However, fundamentals such as supply, demand, stocks and broader economic factors remain more favourable, according to the International Food Policy Research Institute. This helps to limit the likelihood of immediate price spikes compared with previous shocks in 2007, 2010 and 2020,” they said. A number of agri com-

modities heading into the 2026-27 marketing year are well supplied following record yields in 2025-26. This has left inventories at comfortable levels, helping to ease supply concerns, the ING strategists said. **SHOCK IMPACT** AMIS said the ultimate impact of the West Asian crisis on agricultural markets will depend on the duration of the conflict and the end of associated disruptions to energy markets. “A short-lived shock would likely have limited long-term consequences, whereas a prolonged period of elevated energy and fertilizer prices could have more substantial effects on agricultural production, trade and food security, particularly in vulnerable regions,” it said.

Brent crude oil rises above \$80 as Trump ends ceasefire

Bloomberg

Crude oil jumped above \$80 a barrel after US President Donald Trump said a tentative ceasefire with Iran was over, reigniting geopolitical risk premium in prices and triggering investor concern about supply disruptions. Brent futures rose more than 7 per cent to trade near \$80 a barrel, while US West Texas Intermediate also leaped to around \$75.50 a barrel. Diesel futures led the energy complex higher, surging more than 13 per cent after Russia banned diesel exports. Trump warned oil prices could rise further as the administration mulls further strikes on Iran that may include the key export hub of



Kharg Island.

FRESH HOSTILITIES Overnight, US forces completed strikes on more than 80 targets after Iran launched a series of attacks on merchant ships a day earlier. Those three incidents —

targeting a Qatari liquefied natural gas carrier and two large oil tankers — marked the biggest day of attacks since an interim peace deal came into effect in June. Crude oil’s rebound threatens a fresh wave of disruption for still-tense global energy markets. The renewed hostilities in the region stand to complicate the decisions facing shipowners and regional producers over navigating the Strait of Hormuz, which links top OPEC producers in the Persian Gulf to global markets.

INVENTORY DATA Traders also followed US oil inventory data published Wednesday by the Energy Information Administration, which showed the first build in domestic crude stocks since April.

Recurving ‘low’ shifts rain belt to East, N-E

Vinson Kurian
Thiruvananthapuram

A recurving well-marked low-pressure area over north-west Madhya Pradesh and adjoining south-west Uttar Pradesh is set to shift the axis of heavy rainfall from Central and West India towards the East and North-East over the next few days. The India Meteorological Department (IMD) said the system retained its intensity for a second straight day on Wednesday and is expected to meander briefly before turning decisively north-east. Its projected track suggests that the monsoon’s rain-bearing engine is beginning to migrate, offering gradual relief to flood-hit parts of Central India while triggering a fresh spell of heavy rain over the Eastern and North-Eastern States. The shift is being influ-

enced by Typhoon Bavi over the western Pacific, thousands of kilometres away. **MOISTURE TUSSELE** Bavi is diverting monsoon flows as the two systems compete for moisture from the same warm oceanic reservoir. Although it has weakened slightly to a Category 4 storm on the five-step Saffir-Simpson scale, it remains a powerful cyclone as it moves past the Philippines towards Taiwan and southern China. Before beginning its north-eastward journey, the well-marked low unleashed another bout of torrential rain across West and Central India. The seasonal monsoon trough now stretches from north-west Rajasthan to north-east Bangladesh, passing through the centre of the well-marked low. At its eastern end, the trough has shifted entirely

onto land after remaining anchored over the Bay of Bengal for several days, reflecting the absence of a cyclonic circulation or low-pressure area over the Bay to hold it offshore. **FRESH LOW LIKELY** Forecasters expect this to be temporary. Numerical models indicate that a fresh low-pressure area could develop over the Bay within the next seven to eight days, potentially restoring the trough to its more typical sea-linked position and reinvigorating the monsoon over East and North-East India. A secondary trough extends from the north-east Arabian Sea to Sikkim through Gujarat, the well-marked low, south-east Uttar Pradesh and Bihar. Such features are typical of an active monsoon phase, though this trough is expected to weaken as the parent low ac-

celerates north-eastward. **RAIN ALERT** The IMD has forecast widespread to fairly widespread rainfall over much of North-West India over the next few days. Rainfall will simultaneously intensify over East and North-East India as the recurving low pulls the monsoon trough along. While showers will persist over parts of Central India and the Peninsula, the region is likely to see a gradual easing of the intense rainfall that battered it over the past several days. The evolving pattern highlights the monsoon’s characteristic mobility. Rather than weakening, the rain belt is pivoting from the saturated heartland towards the Indo-Gangetic plains and the Eastern and North-Eastern States, where the next phase of the season is set to unfold.

Lakshadweep eyes raising annual tuna production to 50,000 tonnes in 5 years

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi

A stakeholder consultation has drawn up a five-year perspective plan to raise Lakshadweep’s annual tuna and tuna-like fish production to 50,000 tonnes, more than doubling the current catch. Aimed at boosting livelihoods for the island fishing communities, the plan proposes expanding deep-sea tuna fishing, mariculture, seaweed farming and fisheries infrastructure. The meeting, held at the ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI), was attended by representatives of the Union Fisheries Department, the Lakshadweep Fisheries Department, the National Fisheries Development Board (NFDB), the Central Institute of Fisheries Technology (CIFT), the Marine Products Export Development Au-

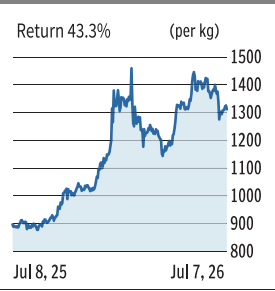
thority (Mpeda) and other agencies, along with fishermen, entrepreneurs and leaders of fishermen’s co-operative societies. **FUTURE PLANS** Prepared as a strategic roadmap for the sector, the plan prioritises marine fisheries, mariculture, post-harvest management, value addition, marketing, infrastructure, capacity building and entrepreneurship under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY). Key proposals include adding 50 deep-sea fishing vessels (below 24 m), launching seaweed cultivation across 5 sq km, and establishing 10 medium-scale ornamental fish-rearing units, besides promoting small fisheries. Lakshadweep offers significant potential for seaweed cultivation and ornamental fish culture, supported by its

4,200 sq km lagoon, 20,000 sq km of territorial waters, and more than 300 species of ornamental reef fish. Infrastructure proposals include boat-building yards, cold storage facilities, 50 value-addition units, two mother vessels, an improved cold chain and marine mechanical workshops, besides measures to modernise the fishing fleet. The CMFRI, designated by the Union Fisheries Department as the nodal agency for preparing the plan, cited its long-standing role in fisheries planning and management in Lakshadweep. Lakshadweep Fisheries Secretary Raj Tilak said enhancing fish production would be the government’s top priority over the next five years. CMFRI Director Grinson George said the institute would provide technical support for the activities.

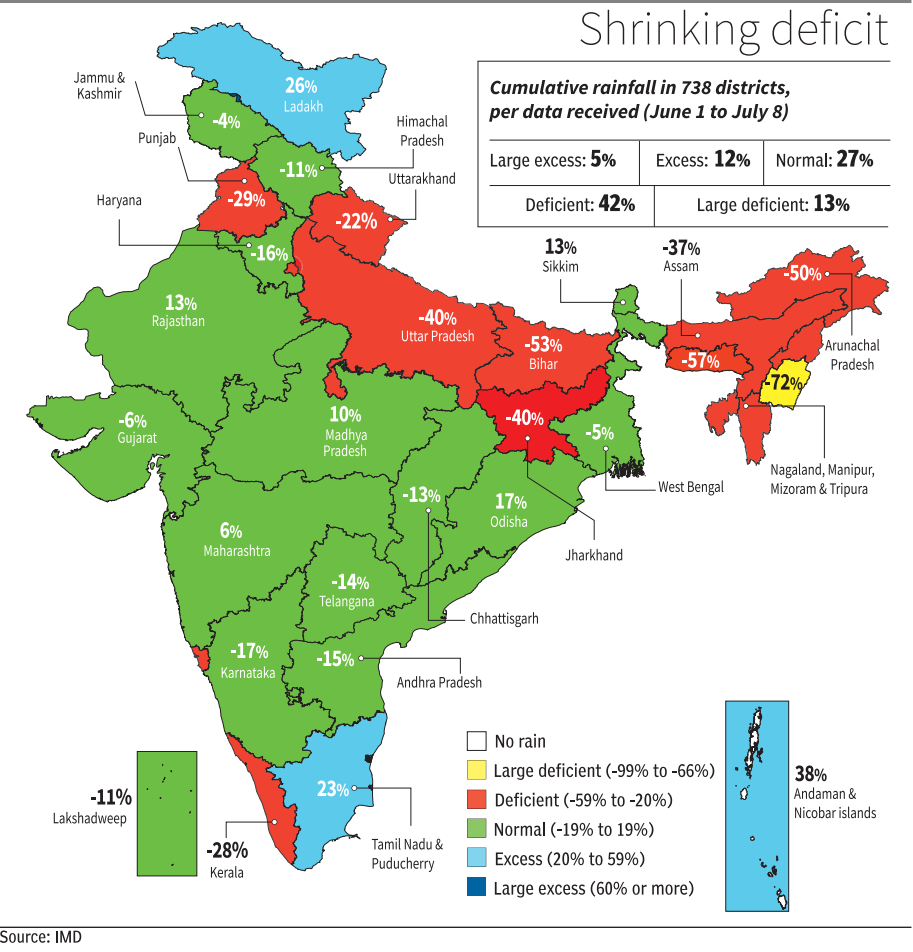
Retain shorts in copper

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Copper futures (₹1,280/kg) have seen some appreciation for nearly two weeks now. But the overall picture appears bearish, and the recent upswing is likely to be temporary. **COMMODITY CALL.** The July futures started a recovery on the back of support at ₹1,240. Now trading at ₹1,280, the contract faces a strong barrier at ₹1,300, where the 21-day moving average coincides. Since the broader trend is weak, we expect copper futures to resume the decline anywhere within the ₹1,280-1,300 price region. Once the downtrend restarts, copper futures can decline to ₹1,230. However, if the contract breaks out of ₹1,300, the outlook could turn positive. In



this scenario, the price could rise to ₹1,340. A breakout of ₹1,340 could lift the contract to ₹1,365. Overall, as it stands, the outlook remains weak and copper futures could witness another leg of a fall. **TRADE STRATEGY** Last week, we recommended selling copper futures if the price rises to ₹1,275. Participants who initiated this trade can retain it. But modify the stop-loss from ₹1,300 to ₹1,310. When the contract drops to ₹1,245, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,265. Book profits at ₹1,230.



‘India’s bio-energy boom fuels demand for enzymes’

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

The accelerating push towards bio-energy and the rapid expansion of the nutrition and wellness market in India are boosting the demand for enzymes and microbial solutions, according to Danish bio-solutions company Novonesis. The demand for bio-solutions is across a range of industries such as bio-fuel manufacturers, dietary supplement makers and bio-fertiliser producers, among others, company officials said. Novonesis, which was formed in 2024 through the merger of Novozymes and Chr. Hansen, is a major player in bio-solutions and believes India’s expanding bio-economy presents significant opportunities as industries increasingly replace conventional chemicals with



Krishna Mohan Puvvada, Regional President, Middle East, India & Africa, Novonesis

biological alternatives that improve efficiency while reducing resource consumption. “Bio-ethanol and bio-fuels are a very, very big topic and Novonesis has been a big part in this conversion process and bringing in this technology, along with other engineering partners,” said Krishna Mohan Puvvada, Regional President, Middle East, India and Africa,

Novonesis. **INDIAN OPERATIONS** While ethanol remains the most visible opportunity, Novonesis sees the broader bioenergy segment, including biogas, biodiesel and other renewable fuels, as an under-penetrated market with significant room for expansion in India. Enzymes play a critical role in improving conversion efficiency, enhancing yields and reducing production costs in these processes, making them increasingly relevant as India scales up its biofuel ambitions, Puvvada said. In India, Novonesis manufactures juice enzymes, probiotics and vitamin K27 at its facilities in Patalganga and Wada, exporting them to global markets. The company has about a tenth of its global workforce, including R&D staff, in India, Puvvada said.

The company has so far invested around ₹4,000 crore in the Indian operations and signed a memorandum of understanding with Maharashtra early this year to invest between ₹2,500 crore and ₹3,000 crore, he said. **DOUBLE-DIGIT GROWTH** Novonesis, he said, had been witnessing a double-digit growth in its India business. Beyond energy, Novonesis is witnessing demand for its bio-solutions from segments such as food and health, animal nutrition and bio-fertilizers, among others. The probiotics space is dramatically expanding as the country becomes a lot more wealthy and a lot more well-informed, Puvvada said. Consumers are increasingly adopting preventive health practices, boosting the demand for probiotics, dietary supplements and nutrition products.

Distilleries supply 68% of contracted 1,048 crore litres of ethanol in 8 months of current season

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Cumulative ethanol supplies reached 717 crore litres until June against contracted volumes of 1,048 crore litres during the current ethanol supply year (ESY) ending October. In the total delivered ethanol, the maximum share was of maize-based biofuel at 36 per cent, followed by 25 per cent by FCI rice and 20 per cent by sugarcane juice, according to the All India Distillers’ Association (AIDA). Grain-based feedstock continue to dominate ethanol production while ensuring greater supply stability through a balanced mix of raw materials in the ongoing Ethanol Supply Year

(November 2025-October 2026), AIDA said in a statement Wednesday. It reflects the growing maturity of India’s biofuel ecosystem. As of June 2026, distilleries already supplied 68 per cent of their contracted obligation, in which the grain-based ethanol distilleries contributed 480 crore litres (or 67 per cent) out of the total ethanol supplied. Sugarcane-based feedstock contribute 238 crore litres (33 per cent), it said. Of the 1,048 crore litres contracted by the oil marketing companies (OMCs) during the ESY, sugar-based distilleries received only 289 crore litres or 28 per cent, whereas the bulk of the order of 759 crore litres (or 72 per cent) went to grain-based distilleries. Accordingly, sugar-based

units have fulfilled over 82 per cent of their contractual obligation whereas the grain-based units could supply only 63 per cent of their commitment. **SUPPLY RESILIENCE** AIDA said that maize continued to be India’s single largest feedstock; with 258 crore litres of ethanol supplied, the latest supply pattern reflects an increasingly diversified feedstock ecosystem. Ethanol produced from surplus FCI grain has reached 177 crore litres, while sugarcane juice has contributed 144 crore litres, B-heavy molasses 82 crore litres, and damaged food grains 45 crore litres. “The balanced contribution from multiple feedstocks has significantly

strengthened supply resilience, reduced dependence on any single agricultural crop and enabled uninterrupted ethanol availability throughout the year,” AIDA said. “The latest ethanol supply data demonstrates that India’s biofuel programme has evolved into a robust and resilient ecosystem, driven by diversified feedstocks. While maize continues to be the largest contributor, the increasing participation of surplus food grains and sugarcane-based feedstocks reflects the strength of a balanced supply chain. This diversification reduces dependence on any single crop, enhances year-round feedstock availability and strengthens India’s energy security,” said Vijendra Singh, President of AIDA.

QUICKLY.

GMR unveils expansion plans for Nagpur airport

Nagpur: GMR Airports Ltd on Wednesday unveiled an ambitious multi-phase modernisation and expansion roadmap for the Nagpur international airport, backed by an initial investment of ₹300 crore to expand annual passenger handling capacity to 30 million. GMR Airports Ltd formally took over the operations of the Dr Babasaheb Ambedkar International Airport in Nagpur last month for the upgradation work. GMR Group's Executive Director and Chief Innovation Officer SGK Kishore said the first phase of development over the next eight years aims to enhance passenger experience, expand operational capacity and position Nagpur as a leading aviation and logistics gateway for Vidarbha and the wider region. **PTI**

Wheat promotion body's conclave in Varanasi today

Chennai: A two-day conclave on "Redefining Wheat Value Chains for a New India" will be held in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh, from July 9. The meet, organised by the Wheat Products Promotion Society (WPPS) along with the Uttar Pradesh Roller Flour Millers Association (UPRFMA), is expected to be one of the biggest wheat industry gatherings of the year in the country. About 350 participants from 81 cities are expected at the conclave, which will also feature over 50 speakers, moderators and panellists from India and overseas. The meet will bring together leaders from flour milling, wheat trade, bakery, bread, biscuits, noodles, pasta, food processing, nutrition, storage, technology, commodity markets, policy and media. **OUR BUREAU**

EPFO shifts to national database; 8.25% interest to be updated by July 15

SYSTEM UPGRADE. The shift will support future UPI withdrawals and faster processing of PF interest, claims

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

With the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) digitising the entire provident fund data into a single national database, members will now be able to verify their 8.25 per cent interest credit for FY26 online by July 15, Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya said on Wednesday.

Migrating to a national database, which happened over the last few days, to make PF access easier is a key step toward broader reform, allowing users to withdraw up to 75 per cent of their accumulated PF funds directly through a UPI interface, the Minister stated.

"Annual interest for FY26 at the rate of 8.25 per cent to 34 crore member accounts, estimated at over ₹1.44 lakh crore, will be auto-processed



Union Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya **ANI**

and then verified by Field Authorities before being credited to the member account balances. Members will be able to view the interest credit in their passbook by July 15," the Minister told reporters.

Earlier, after the EPF interest rate was announced, it typically took until October–November for the interest to be credited to members' accounts, he said, adding that he was himself monitoring

the logistics migrations to ensure a smooth process.

Of the 34 crore member accounts, only nine crore are active. However, members must link their previous PF account numbers to their latest UAN-based account numbers to obtain a consolidated view of the parked amount.

Described as EPFO 2.01 CITES Project (Centralised IT Enabled Services), the move is designed to enhance

member convenience, improve EPFO operational efficiency, thereby overall deliver transparent and seamless citizen-centric services.

BETTER NAVIGATION

Upon logging in to the portal, members can access a unified digital interface to view their membership details, provident fund balances, claim status, pensionable service records, and benefits availed.

A member's claims will undergo automated pre-validation prior to processing at EPFO offices. Any deficiencies or discrepancies will be identified upfront, and appropriate guidance will be provided to members, significantly reducing claim rejections and improving first-time acceptance rates, as per the Minister.

Members will also be able to know the eligible amount

they can withdraw from their PF account under the permitted types of withdrawals and make informed choices, an improvement over the earlier opaque system.

A substantial proportion of member claims for advances has been increased from ₹1 lakh to up to ₹5 Lakh, from accounts fully KYC-linked and validated, will be processed through an auto-settlement mechanism. The portal will also address queries on claim processing.

Under the revised system, interest in final PF settlements will now be calculated up to the date of payment authorisation.

This is an improvisation since earlier, the interest was calculated only up to the last day of the previous month. This ensures that members receive the benefit of additional interest for the intervening period, Mandaviya stated.

Maharashtra to legalise bike taxis from Aug 1, permits only for domicile holders



ON THE ROAD. The government estimates that between 4 lakh and 4.5 lakh bike taxis are currently operating across Maharashtra

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Maharashtra will roll out a bike taxi policy from August 1, bringing an estimated 4-4.5 lakh bike taxis under a regulatory framework while restricting permits to domicile holders who can understand Marathi.

State Transport Minister Pratap Sarnaik told the legislature on Tuesday that the Transport Department is expected to clear the policy by the end of July.

"We expect the department's clearance by the end of July. The new policy will come into effect across the State from August 1," Sarnaik said during Question Hour.

The policy marks a reversal from the State's earlier crackdown on app-based bike taxi operators after provisional licences granted to aggregators such as Uber, Rapido and Ola were cancelled earlier this year over alleged non-compliance with State regulations.

NEW FRAMEWORK

Under the new framework, only Maharashtra domicile

holders will be eligible to obtain bike taxi permits. Drivers must hold a valid driving licence under the Motor Vehicles Act, 1988, along with a public service vehicle badge prescribed under the Maharashtra Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989.

"To ensure employment for the young men and women of Maharashtra, the rules for bike taxis have been modified. Moving forward, anyone wishing to operate a bike taxi will have to pay ₹5 per day to the government. Additionally, 2 per cent of the amount will be deducted per ride, which will be utilised for welfare schemes," Sarnaik said.

Officials expect the new policy to formalise the sector, create employment opportunities for local residents and generate revenue currently lost because of unregulated operations.

The issue was raised in the Assembly by Shiv Sena MLA Dilip Lande, who said auto-rickshaw and taxi drivers were facing increasing competition from unauthorised app-based taxis and bike taxi services operating across Mumbai and the Mumbai Metropolitan Region.

Gujarat to unveil data centre policy to boost digital infra

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Gujarat plans to unveil a data centre policy aimed at drawing investments in hyperscale data centres, cloud infrastructure and AI-led digital services.

Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel will unveil the 'Gujarat Data Centre Policy 2026-29,' a maiden initiative to provide a dedicated framework to attract investments.

The policy will complement the State's broader push to emerge as a leading destination for new-age technology sectors, includ-

ing artificial intelligence, semiconductors, global capability centres (GCCs) and fintech. The policy will enhance the State's competitiveness against established data centre hubs such as Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu and Telangana, while reinforcing its ambition to become a leading digital infrastructure destination in India.

Over the past three years, the State has witnessed a series of announcements by hyperscale operators, cloud infrastructure providers and AI-focused developers.

The momentum began gathering pace with projects in GIFT City by operators



Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel

such as CtrlS Datacenters and Yotta Data Services, before expanding to Jamnagar, Dholera and the Ahmedabad region.

Gujarat's growing appeal,

driven by reliable power availability, improving fibre connectivity, strategic port infrastructure, a supportive policy environment and increasing access to renewable energy, has helped create this new ecosystem.

PROJECTS UNDERWAY

The investment pipeline has accelerated further over the past two years with several largescale proposals spanning AI-ready campuses, hyperscale facilities and edge infrastructure.

Among the biggest announcements are Reliance Industries' proposed AI-focused data centre campus at

Jamnagar and Larsen & Toubro's planned 250 MW AI-ready data centre at Dholera. Other projects announced by companies, including Henox and SEGNO, have further strengthened Gujarat's digital infrastructure ecosystem.

ENABLING ECOSYSTEM

Government officials expect the new policy to further accelerate this investment momentum by creating an enabling ecosystem for developers through incentives, streamlined approvals and support for sustainable, energy-efficient infrastructure.

Enforcement Directorate freezes ₹440 cr held in TMC's bank accounts

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Enforcement Directorate has issued orders to freeze the All India Trinamool Congress' (TMC) bank deposits totalling over ₹440 crore under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), suspecting gross misuse of political funding.

The orders were issued under Section 17 (1-A) of the PMLA to freeze three private bank accounts together holding ₹440.42 crore, ED officials said.

On Tuesday, the agency's sleuths carried out searches at five locations across Kolkata and adjoining areas to probe suspected ₹150 crore fund-routing through the TMC's bank accounts.

The officials have found suspicious financial transactions allegedly funnelled through aviation and travel



companies into bank accounts linked to the TMC.

ED officials stated that the premises of Carewell Aviation Pvt Ltd — a West Bengal registered company dealing in aircraft sales, private jet charters and leasing — and its directors and a "purported electoral trust" were covered in the searches.

Carewell is said to have provided chartered aircraft to the top brass of the TMC during Mamata Banerjee's regime. Rebel TMC leaders have questioned largescale

use of the chartered flights.

The agency took over a case registered by the Kolkata Police, which last month stopped banking operations in three accounts of the TMC, acting on complaints filed by rebel MLAs.

POLITICAL FUNDS

They demanded a probe into the source of the political funds received by the TMC.

The ED's raid against the electoral trust operating out of Kolkata is meant to investigate allegedly unaccounted money structurally introduced as pseudo-legal political donations.

The Mamata Banerjee-led faction has filed a petition in Calcutta High Court challenging the freezing of the party accounts.

While hearing the petition on July 2, the Calcutta High Court directed the private bank concerned to disclose the amount deposited in those accounts.

DRDO tests Pinaka rockets with 60 km reach

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Strengthening the country's firepower capabilities, the Defence Research & Development Organisation (DRDO) conducted a successful flight-test of the Pinaka long range guided rocket (LRGR) at the Integrated Test Range, Chandipur, demonstrating its enhanced reach to hit target at a minimum range of 60 km.

The original Pinaka Mark-I rockets have range of about 38-40 km. Demonstrating all in-flight manoeuvres as planned, the LRGR hit the target with textbook precision following the predicted trajectory, the Ministry of Defence said in a statement.

All the deployed range instruments tracked the flight throughout its trajectory, the Ministry added.

Pinaka's single battery of six launchers can fire 72 rockets in about 44 seconds.

Glacier water breathes life into Leh's wasteland

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

Large swathes of land that remained barren for centuries in the Himalayan cold desert of Leh are showing signs of life, with bright yellow mustard flowers and green foliage replacing the dusty, windswept landscape in what officials describe as the first visible outcome of an ambitious ecological restoration experiment.

The transformation has unfolded on nearly 800 acres of arid land near Spituk, where glacial meltwater was channelled across the parched terrain before mustard seeds were sown.

In little over a month, the once-barren expanse has turned into a patchwork of yellow blooms and green vegetation, demonstrating how a relatively simple freshwater recharge technique can revive land long considered uncultivable.

The project was launched in May by Lieutenant Gov-



NEW LEASE OF LIFE. The transformation unfolded on about 800 acres of arid land near Spituk, where glacial meltwater was channelled across the terrain to grow mustard crop **IMRAN NISSAR**

ernor Vinai Kumar Saxena as part of an ecological restoration initiative.

SOIL FERTILITY

The initiative seeks to explore whether glacier-fed irrigation can restore soil moisture and support vegetation in one of India's most inhospitable landscapes.

According to experts, over 90 per cent of Ladakh's land is barren and devoid of vegetation. The region's sandy soil

succeeds, it can help make barren land cultivable," Namgial said.

Sharing photographs of the mustard fields on social media platform 'X', Saxena said the project had begun yielding "remarkable results".

He said that after the arid soil was treated with fresh glacier water for a few days, mustard seeds were sown and, in little over a month, widespread germination had transformed the barren landscape into a vibrant green cover.

The Lieutenant Governor described the initiative as an example of how simple, cost-effective scientific interventions could help tackle complex environmental challenges. He said the project was inspired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call to reverse land degradation and desertification and reflected the Union Territory administration's commitment to ecological regeneration, sustainable agriculture and a greener future for Ladakh.

Heritage Foods justifies use of term 'fresh paneer' on label, counters FSSAI

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

Heritage Foods has clarified that its 'fresh paneer' claim talks about the product's "fresh, refrigerated and preservative-free nature."

The clarification follows the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) issuing a notice to the Hyderabad-based company, maintaining that the claim 'fresh paneer' didn't satisfy the conditions stipulated under Schedule V for the use of the term 'fresh'.

NO PRESERVATIVE

"We are aware of the concerns raised regarding the labelling of our Heritage Fresh Paneer and have submitted

our detailed response to the concerned authority," the company said.

"Heritage Paneer is manufactured using pasteurised milk of high quality under hygienic conditions, while preserving the intrinsic nature of the product. As we use no preservatives, we store and transport under refrigerated conditions to ensure that consumers can enjoy the freshness of our safe and hygienic product," it explained.

The product label carried all mandatory declarations including ingredients used, nutritional information, manufacturing date and use-by date enabling consumers to make an informed choice, Srideep Kesavan, Chief Executive Officer, Heritage Foods Ltd, said in a statement.

Food safety authority issues notices to Lotte, Kubera Foods, Ferns N Petals on misleading claims

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

In a fresh move, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has issued notices to Lotte India, Ferns N Petals and Kubera Foods for misleading claims and violation of labelling norms on food products.

In a social media post on Instagram, FSSAI said these companies had been directed to explain within seven days why action should not be initiated against them under the provisions of the FSS Act, 2006.

FSSAI issued the notice to Lotte India as "the company utilised non-compliant pre-printed labels bearing the old company name, Lotte India Corporation Ltd, without obtaining prior approval." Also, products such as Lotte

The companies have been directed to explain within seven days why action should not be initiated against them under the FSS Act, 2006

Choco Pie with Rich Marshmallow, Lotte Choco Pie Real Orange and Lotte Choco Pie Choco Burst bear the claim '100 per cent vegetarian', which has been found to be misleading, it added.

It also observed that its products 'PEPERO Crunchy Biscuit Sticks' and 'PEPERO Original Biscuit Sticks' do not provide nutritional information in the manner prescribed in the regula-

tions. "Lolly Bliss Lollipop (orange, strawberry and kacha mango flavours) do not comply with vitamin levels under the provisions of the FSS (Advertising & Claims) Regulations," it added.

Similarly, FSSAI said the FruitZ Eclairs (mango, orange and strawberry flavours) bear a product name that is likely to create a misleading impression as the products do not contain fruits.

"Further, the mandatory disclaimer for the brand/trade name, as required under the FSS (Advertising & Claims) Regulations, has not been provided on the front of the pack," FSSAI noted.

MISLEADING CLAIMS

In the case of Kubera Foods, FSSAI issued notice over misleading claims on its product 'Soft and Fresh

Cream Bun Pineapple'.

The Authority added that usage of claims such as "pure", "fresh" and "natural" are in violation of regulations. It also said the front-of-pack claims "100 per cent natural" and "No preservatives, colours & flavours" while the product label declares "preservative, synthetic food colour and added flavouring substances."

In the case of Ferns N Petals Pvt Ltd, the FSSAI said, "Notice issued regarding misleading claims, including 'premium chocolate' on the front of the pack despite the product containing hydrogenated vegetable fat."

The product was also found to have labelling deficiencies related to per cent recommended dietary allowance declaration and ingredient disclosure, the FSSAI said.

Vizhinjam port: Kerala to study Adani's plan to sell 49 per cent stake to MSC

Our Bureau
Kochi

The Kerala Cabinet on Wednesday decided to constitute an Empowered Committee, headed by the Chief Secretary, to examine the Adani Group's proposal to divest 49 per cent stake in Vizhinjam port to MSC.

Addressing reporters, Chief Minister VD Satheesan reiterated that the UDF government was unaware of the proposed stake transfer until reports appeared in the media. He said on the day the Adani Group intimated SEBI about the proposed deal, the State government conveyed its displeasure over not being informed earlier.

Following this, the company formally sought the government's approval for the share transfer, as re-

quired under the concession agreement.

Responding to Opposition leader Pinarayi Vijayan's criticism, he dismissed the claim that the MSC Group could establish a monopoly at Vizhinjam port, pointing out that the agreement mandates the port to function as a common-user facility.

TO ADVERTISE PLEASE CONTACT

Chennai	: 044 - 28576300
Coimbatore	: 0422 - 2212572
Madurai	: 0452 - 2528497
Trichy	: 0431 - 2302801
Puducherry	: 0413 - 2224111

thehindu **businessline.**

QUICKLY.

Marksans Pharma to buy Germany's ABCnow

Mumbai: Marksans Pharma Ltd announced on Wednesday that it has signed a definitive agreement to acquire 100 per cent of ABCnow GmbH, a pharmaceutical wholesale and distribution company based in Flensburg, Germany, for a cash consideration of €892,384 (₹81 lakh). The deal is expected to close by July 31. OUR BUREAU

Natco Pharma to raise stake in Adcock Ingram

Hyderabad: The board of directors of Natco Pharma has approved the acquisition of an additional shareholding in Adcock Ingram Holdings Proprietary Ltd at an investment of up to ₹1,400 crore. This acquisition is valued at ₹1,069 crore at the prevailing exchange rate, and will take Natco's shareholding in Adcock Ingram from to 49 per cent. OUR BUREAU

Navi Mumbai airport gets nod to import medicines



Mumbai: In an effort to strengthen the pharmaceutical supply chain, the Health Ministry has green-lighted the import of medicines through the recently inaugurated Navi Mumbai airport in Maharashtra. "The amendment to Rule 43A of the Drugs Rules, 1945 now includes Navi Mumbai in the list of airports through which drugs may be imported into the country," said a note from the Ministry. The total number of ports of entry (road/rail/ship/air) now stands at 42. OUR BUREAU

Airlines seek 5% GST on ATF with full tax credit to help reduce costs

CLEARING THE AIR. FIA says the move will improve airline liquidity, make air travel more affordable

Rohit Vaid
New Delhi

India's leading domestic airlines have urged the Centre to bring Aviation Turbine Fuel (ATF) under the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime at a rate of 5 per cent with full Input Tax Credit (ITC), arguing that the move will significantly reduce operating costs, improve airline liquidity and make air travel more affordable.

In a representation to the Ministry of Civil Aviation reviewed by *businessline*, the Federation of Indian Airlines (FIA), which represents major scheduled carriers, including IndiGo, Air India and SpiceJet, sought immediate government intervention to



HEADWINDS. ATF accounts for 40% of airline operating expenditure, making it the single-largest cost component

abolish Central Excise Duty and State Value Added Tax (VAT) on ATF, and replace the existing tax structure with a uniform 5 per cent GST regime carrying full input tax credit benefits.

Notably, the representation assumes significance as the GST Council is expected to meet in Kolkata later this month, where industry

stakeholders expect the issue of bringing ATF under the GST framework to come up for consideration once again.

GST FRAMEWORK

According to the industry body, ATF currently remains outside the GST framework despite Constitutional provisions enabling its inclu-

sion, resulting in airlines bearing irrecoverable Central Excise Duty and State VAT that substantially inflate operating costs.

The FIA stated that ATF accounts for nearly 40 per cent of airline operating expenditure, making it the single-largest cost component for carriers. Besides, the industry body argued that ATF presently attracts around 11 per cent Central Excise Duty, along with State VAT ranging between 1 per cent and 29 per cent, neither of which is available as input tax credit to airlines.

It added that the absence of a seamless credit chain also results in cascading taxes embedded in fuel prices.

Furthermore, the FIA said

India's taxation framework for ATF remains an outlier globally, noting that Germany, UK, Australia and Canada levy VAT or GST on aviation fuel, but allow full input tax credit, effectively eliminating the tax burden on commercial airlines.

According to the representation, eliminating irrecoverable taxes on ATF could reduce delivered fuel costs by around 28 per cent, lowering overall airline operating costs by nearly 8-9 per cent.

Additionally, the industry body argued that lower operating costs could eventually translate into reduced airfares, stimulating passenger demand in India's highly price-sensitive aviation market.

Hotels rebound in Apr-June quarter on travel demand

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

Hotel chains registered double-digit growth in the June-end quarter on the back of strong travel demand. Last year, properties in North India had seen a dip in business following the Pahalgam terror attack and Operation Sindoor. With no geopolitical headwinds this time, hotels are seeing a rebound.

The growth trend is visible in air traffic, too, with domestic airlines carrying 9.5 per cent more passengers in May on a year-on-year basis. "The April-June quarter has been positive for us, with our portfolio delivering approximately 18 per cent year-on-year growth compared to the

same period last year. This growth was driven by healthy occupancy levels and continued strength in average daily rates, particularly across key leisure markets, resulting in strong RevPAR (revenue per available room) performance," said Nikhil Sharma, MD and COO, Radisson Hotel Group (South Asia).

Sharma said the North Indian markets saw strong performance this year. "Srinagar, Pahalgam, Sonmarg, Shimla and Jammu witnessed encouraging momentum, reflecting Indian travellers' continued preference for domestic leisure destinations," he added.

ROOM RATES

According to HVS Anarock, occupancy levels across most key hotel markets re-



TAKING A BREAK. Srinagar, Pahalgam, Sonmarg, Shimla and Jammu witnessed encouraging momentum, reflecting travellers' continued preference for domestic leisure destinations

corded a strong year-on-year improvement in May, compared to last year when demand had been impacted by war-like conditions in the

Ahmedabad," it said. Average room rates rose 9-11 per cent in May on a y-o-y basis to ₹7,900-8,100 with all markets showing growth except Kolkata "The June-end quarter has been encouraging for Leisure Hotels Group, with the company recording overall 30 per cent growth compared to the same period last year," said Shahzad Aslam, Sales Director.

Demand is being increasingly led by experience-led leisure travel, said Aslam. Last-minute and online bookings continue to gain momentum, with Leisure Hotels properties in Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Himachal Pradesh, Rajasthan and Goa witnessing increase in occupancy and rates, he added.

Lion-el hearted show!



Leadership shake-up continues as three senior executives exit Axis Bank

Bloomberg

Axis Bank, the top arranger of debt markets, has lost three senior executives, adding to a big reshuffle taking place at private-sector lenders.

Anil Agarwal, President and Group Head of institutional clients coverage; Vikas Shinde, who once headed the debt capital market team, and Jimmy Tavadia, Group Head of trading, have resigned from Axis Bank, according to people familiar with the matter.

The departures come as the lender reorganises key positions in its corporate banking and other teams. The people declined to be named discussing private information.

BANDHAN BANK CPO

HDFC Bank, the top private-sector lender, recently named Puneet Sharma from Axis Bank as its Chief Financial Officer. Separately, Bandhan Bank's Chief Finan-



cial Officer Rajeev Mantri stepped down.

Axis Bank and the departing executives did not immediately reply to an e-mail seeking comment.

Agarwal spent more than two decades at the lender, overseeing strategic relationships with government entities, public sector undertakings and financial institutions, according to his LinkedIn profile.

Shinde, also at the bank for about two decades, largely worked in the debt capital market team, while Tavadia joined the lender in 2019 and specialised in rates and forex trading, his LinkedIn profile showed.

Centre tells automakers to launch cyber security management systems from Oct

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Following the discovery of Bluetooth-related BMS vulnerabilities in e-rickshaws, the government has come out with an urgent advisory for all automobile manufacturers to begin building systematic Cyber Security Management Systems (CSMS) and Software Update Management Systems (SUMS) from October.

This includes securing over-the-air updates, implementing robust user authentication and validating software integrity, especially in electric vehicles.

E-RICKSHAWS HIT

Last week (July 1-2), incidents were reported of remote shut down of moving e-rickshaws via Chinese apps such

as BAT-BMS. Therefore, the Ministry of Heavy Industries sent the advisory to Society of Indian Automobile Manufacturers (SIAM), Automotive Component Manufacturers Association of India (ACMA), Automotive Research Association of India (ARAI) and International Centre for Automotive Technology (iCAT), to enforce security audits, eliminate unsecured default settings and collaborate on cyber safety design protocols.

"Manufacturers must immediately begin building Cyber Security Management System and Software Update Management System in preparation for draft Ministry of Road Transport and Highways standards AIS-189 and AIS-190, proposed for phased rollout starting October 1," sources quoting the MHI advisory told *business-*

line. MHI said while recent safety updates under AIS-156 and AIS-038 Rev.2 had successfully integrated telematics and connected features into modern battery architectures, these standards do not mandate specific wireless technologies nor do they guarantee immunity from cyber threats.

SAFEGUARDS IN PLACE

To safeguard the industry, it has advised SIAM and all testing agencies to take immediate steps, including advising original equipment manufacturers to audit their battery communication interfaces, and eliminate unsecured default settings, weak authentication or unprotected over-the-air pathways.

It has also advised them to work directly with the Ministry of Road Transport and Highways, Ministry of Elec-

tronics and IT and other key stakeholders to establish better, more resilient cyber safety design protocols from the factory level.

"No single standard can eliminate every digital risk, but implementing AIS-189 and AIS-190 is a decisive step toward building a trustworthy connected vehicle ecosystem in India. SIAM and ACMA may also circulate this advisory to all manufacturers including OEMs and component makers. It may be ensured that these safety protocols are prioritised," said the MHI advisory.

The advisory added that any further vulnerability or information in this regard should also be brought to the attention of the Ministry immediately. SIAM confirmed receiving the advisory and said it has forwarded the same to its members.

Asean-India joint panel sets strict timeline to speed up trade pact review

Amity Sen
New Delhi

The Asean-India Trade in Goods Agreement (AITIGA) joint committee, which is seeking a speedy conclusion to the review of the bilateral free trade pact, has set strict timelines for various sub-committees to finalise pending chapters, said the Commerce Department on Wednesday.

The sub-committees are reviewing key areas under the agreement, including market access and national treatment, rules of origin, customs procedures and trade facilitation. The review comes against India's growing concern over its widening merchandise trade deficit with the Asean bloc.

"The joint committee provided strategic guidance

to the sub-committees in their respective areas of work, and urged them to expedite the finalisation of the outstanding chapters under the AITIGA review. To maintain the momentum of negotiations, the sub-committees were assigned time-bound deliverables and encouraged to work closely towards achieving tangible outcomes within the agreed timelines," said the Commerce Department in a statement.

MARKET ACCESS

India and Asean had hoped to conclude the review during the Asean-India Summit in October 2025, but differences over issues such as market access and rules of origin delayed the process. "India has sought greater market access to the Asean market to increase exports and reduce the trade deficit,



but Asean, too, wants lower import duties for some of its products. Also, India wants tighter rules of origin to keep out Chinese goods," said a source tracking the matter.

New Delhi is hosting the 13th AITIGA joint committee meeting from July 6-10 with the focus on achieving tangible outcomes within the agreed timelines. Delegations from all Asean member states — Brunei, Cambodia, Indonesia, Lao PDR, Malaysia, Myanmar, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Vietnam — participated

in the meeting, the statement added.

"Asean remains one of India's key trading partners, accounting for around 11 per cent of India's global trade. Bilateral trade between India and Asean reached \$128 billion in 2025-26, reflecting the strong economic partnership between the two sides and providing further opportunities to expand trade and investment cooperation," the statement noted.

However, India's trade deficit with Asean has widened sharply to \$45.2 billion in FY25 from less than \$7 billion in 2010 when AITIGA was implemented. Experts attribute the widening deficit to lower tariff reduction commitments by Thailand and Vietnam, as well as poor utilisation of the agreement by Indian exporters.

After the initial growth, rush for GLP-1 weightloss and diabetes drugs plateaus

PT Jyothi Datta
Mumbai

After the race to launch generic semaglutide for weightloss and diabetes, the anti-diabetes market has stabilised even as innovator drugs hold their own place in the market, reveals Pharmtrack's data for June.

Innovator companies Novo Nordisk with brands Wegovy and Ozempic (injectable versions of semaglutide for weightloss and diabetes) and Eli Lilly with its weightloss brand Mounjaro continue to lead the pack at a slightly subdued level. "The exponential growth in the initial months has plateaued," noted Sheetal Sapale, Vice-President, Commercial, at Pharmarack Technologies.

The trend over the last three months is unlikely to



change as innovator products hold their own place and generics have onboarded patients who were looking for less expensive products, Sapale told *businessline*, adding that monthly sales from now on will be incremental.

BIG CONTRIBUTORS

The GLP-1 drugs market is now pegged at ₹2055 crore, with Lilly's Mounjaro at ₹1,300 crore for the 12 months up to June 2026. In the same period, the sema-

glutide brands posted sales of ₹649 crore. However, four of the innovator brands — Wegovy, Ozempic, Poviztra (second Wegovy brand sold by Emcure) and Extensor (second Ozempic brand sold by Abbott) — contributed to 18 per cent of the unit sales for the month, or 40 percent of the value sales, said Sapale. The 31 generic semaglutide brands contributed to 82 per cent of the unit sales of the month, the industry data tracker said.

Generic versions of semaglutide from companies including Sun Pharma, Torrent, Zydus, Alkem, Natco and Dr Reddy's Laboratories, for example, entered the domestic market when a patent on the drug expired late in March.

Other GLP-1 drugs Dulaglutide and Liraglutide locked ₹67 crore and ₹37 crore, respectively. "Though

the market looks upbeat, the growth momentum seems to have started plateauing, the industry tracker said. While semaglutide generics had expanded the size of the market, that also seems to have been optimally covered now," it added.

The innovators drugs continue to show steady growth month on month, "indicating loyal prescriber base and eligible patient onboarding", the tracker added.

The industry data further revealed that after the initial dip in demand in March 2026, probably because of the generics launch in the same category, Tirzepatide recovered and grew beyond its pre-semaglutide generics sales numbers. And while it has lost some ground from there, data point to sales now being in line with its pre-semaglutide generics sales numbers.

India eyes OSAT for semicon manufacturing ecosystem

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

As India seeks to establish itself in the global semiconductor supply chain, industry executives are betting on Outsourced Semiconductor Assembly and Test (OSAT) facilities as the country's most practical entry point, citing government support, rising domestic demand and supply chain diversification as key growth drivers.

India has attracted ₹64,000 crore in announced investments in OSAT and ATMP facilities under the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM).

Major projects include Tata Electronics' ₹27,000 crore assembly and test plant in Assam, CG Semi's ₹7,600 crore OSAT unit, Kaynes Semicon's ₹3,300 crore facility, HCL Group-Foxconn joint venture's ₹3,700 crore OSAT plant in Uttar Pradesh and Suchi Semicon's \$100-

million OSAT facility in Gujarat.

GOVT PUSH

The OSAT momentum is the result of a convergence of government policy, industry participation, growing domestic demand and global supply chain diversification. ISM has reduced investment risk and created confidence among global investors, while the need for resilient supply chains has encouraged companies to expand their manufacturing footprint," Ashok Chandak, President of IESA and SEMI India, highlighted.

He added that OSAT is a strategic starting point for building a globally competitive semiconductor ecosystem. It enables India to build capabilities, credibility and ecosystem depth before moving up the value chain further. Moreover, a typical OSAT facility requires an investment of \$300-\$2 billion, whereas a leading-edge semiconductor fab can cost

\$10-\$25 billion or more. OSATs also have a shorter gestation period, lower execution risk and can reach commercial production much faster, making them an ideal entry point.

"India already contributes over 20 per cent of the world's semiconductor design talent. By adding OSAT capabilities, India can offer a stronger end-to-end value proposition from chip design and validation to packaging and testing," Chandak observed.

While government incentives have accelerated investments, India's long-term competitiveness as an OSAT destination goes beyond financial support. Ashok Mehta, Chairman of Suchi Semicon, noted that India's electronics manufacturing sector is growing rapidly, creating strong domestic demand for semiconductors across smartphones, consumer electronics, automotive, industrial equipment and telecom. "This gives OSAT play-

ers the advantage of being closer to both customers and manufacturing partners.

Indian OSAT plants can also become a trusted manufacturing partner as global companies diversify their supply chains. "Businesses are looking for resilience alongside cost competitiveness, and India is well-positioned to serve as an alternative manufacturing destination. The country's focus on developing a complete semiconductor ecosystem, including design, fabrication, packaging, testing and supporting industries, is supporting this proposition," Mehta emphasised.

Suchi Semicon is focused on workhorse packages that power everyday electronics and automotive systems. These are high-volume, high-reliability formats that form the backbone of consumer, industrial and automotive electronics, as India has zero domestic capacity today and 100 per cent import dependence.

Company	Prev	Close	Open	High	Low	52 Wk High	52 Wk Low	PE	BSE CI
Park Hotels	124.21	124.21	124.21	129.20	120.51	447.59	168.89	95.10	-
Park MedWor	285.25	273.90	283.70	288.25	269.25	991.55	350.00	138.10	-
Pattam Co	87.10	88.10	88.10	88.10	87.10	168.20	87.10	12.70	-
Pattanjali Fd	41.50	40.90	41.40	41.40	40.70	173.23	196.10	40.25	-
Patel Engg [1]	33.46	31.64	33.34	33.14	31.74	747.69	48.85	22.08	8 31.65
Patel Retail	9.41	9.41	9.41	9.41	9.41	10.28	9.41	10.28	9.41
Paushak	53.75	52.60	53.40	54.10	52.10	18.46	63.30	34.50	-
PayTm	124.60	123.24	124.00	125.30	121.00	359.74	118.80	89.10	-
Pe Fintech	168.00	156.20	159.30	159.70	155.50	299.59	197.40	136.40	-
Pe Fintech [1]	168.00	156.20	159.30	159.70	155.50	299.59	197.40	136.40	-
Pe Jeweller [1]	9.41	9.41	9.41	9.41	9.41	10.28	9.41	10.28	9.41
PCBL	31.80	29.70	31.20	31.25	29.50	104.32	49.30	32.50	-
PDS	36.00	34.60	35.80	36.80	34.40	31.08	43.30	24.60	-
PDS [1]	36.00	34.60	35.80	36.80	34.40	31.08	43.30	24.60	-
PERSTAR IND [5]	4884.80	4769.50	4884.80	4910.40	4730.00	662.31	659.00	42.65	14 16.60
Petronet LNG	27.90	27.60	27.10	27.65	27.50	466.14	17.60	23.45	11 21.85
Pfizer Ltd.	453.70	452.10	453.70	468.00	450.60	342.7	589.00	436.10	72 45.26
Pfizer Ltd. [1]	453.70	452.10	453.70	468.00	450.60	342.7	589.00	436.10	72 45.26
PGL [5]	197.0	195.10	196.00	199.20	193.10	54.89	211.00	118.00	139 195.25
Phoenix Mill [2]	20.70	20.20	20.20	20.70	20.10	480.03	213.00	140.03	245 20.25
Pharmaceuticals	652.30	257.30	264.90	264.90	255.10	15.18	482.00	254.05	25 257.90
Piccadilly Adm	66.45	64.55	66.55	66.95	63.85	181.80	80.50	51.00	-
Piccadilly Adm [1]	66.45	64.55	66.55	66.95	63.85	181.80	80.50	51.00	-
Pine Labs	147.96	142.07	147.25	148.29	141.39	109.19	84.40	76 157.03	
Piramal Fin	215.90	212.40	215.00	210.60	211.55	222.00	126.00	-	-
Piramal Fin [1]	215.90	212.40	215.00	210.60	211.55	222.00	126.00	-	-
Piramal Fin [2]	215.90	212.40	215.00	210.60	211.55	222.00	126.00	-	-
Pix Transm	174.50	174.10	174.00	178.40	171.17	27.99	139.00	120.10	36 92.75
Platinumind	23.28	22.84	23.51	23.89	22.77	83.47	34.20	183.50	-
Platinumind [1]	23.28	22.84	23.51	23.89	22.77	83.47	34.20	183.50	-
Pnt Gbts	86.98	85.84	86.98	86.98	84.32	61.22	119.84	58.75	9 85.73
PNB Housing	119.70	107.20	110.30	110.90	106.60	152.04	111.60	73.00	12 107.20
PNF Infra [2]	23.84	23.18	23.27	24.06	23.73	69.05	31.80	15.95	18 23.70
PNC Infra [2]	23.84	23.18	23.27	24.06	23.73	69.05	31.80	15.95	18 23.70
Pokarna Ltd [2]	98.80	98.20	98.70	102.20	97.90	66.98	114.35	69.25	-
Poly Media [5]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [1]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [2]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [3]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [4]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [5]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [6]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [7]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [8]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [9]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [10]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [11]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [12]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [13]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [14]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [15]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [16]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [17]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [18]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [19]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [20]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [21]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [22]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [23]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [24]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [25]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [26]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [27]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [28]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [29]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [30]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [31]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [32]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [33]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [34]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [35]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [36]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [37]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [38]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [39]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [40]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [41]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [42]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [43]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [44]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [45]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [46]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [47]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [48]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [49]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [50]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [51]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [52]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [53]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [54]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [55]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [56]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [57]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [58]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [59]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [60]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [61]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [62]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [63]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [64]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [65]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [66]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [67]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [68]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00
Poly Media [5] [69]	166.90	164.30	166.10	168.40	165.00	106.40	224.25	118.40	48 161.00